



G. B. Lawrence

CHILDREN'S BOOK
COLLECTION



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A
T O K E N
F O R
C H I L D R E N :
B E I N G

An exact Account of the Conversion,
holy and exemplary Lives, and joyful Deaths
of several YOUNG CHILDREN.

By JAMES JANEWAY,
Minister of the Gospel.

To which is added,

A TOKEN for the CHILDREN of
NEW-ENGLAND.

O R,

Some Examples of CHILDREN, in whom
the Fear of GOD was remarkably budding before
they died; in several Parts of *New-England.*

Preserved and published for the Encouragement of
PIETY in other Children.

With New Additions.

BOSTON, in NEW-ENGLAND:
Printed and sold by THOMAS and JOHN FLEET,
at the BIBLE and HEART, in Cornhill, 1781.

To all Parents, School-Masters and
School-Mistresses, or any who have any
Hand in the Education of Children.

Dear Friends,

I HAVE oft thought that Christ speaks to you, as Pharaoh's daughter did to Moses's mother, Take this Child and nurse it for me. O Sirs, consider what a precious Jewel is committed to your charge, what an advantage you have to show your love to Christ, to stock the next generation with Noble Plants, and what a joyful account you may make if you be faithful. Remember, Souls, Christ and Grace cannot be overvalued, I confess you have some advantages, but let that only excite your diligence; the salvation of Souls, the commendation of your Master, the greatness of your reward and everlasting Glory, will pay for all. Remember the Devil is at work hard, wicked ones are industrious, and corrupt nature is a rugged, knotty piece to hew. But be not discouraged, I am almost as much afraid of your laziness and unfaithfulness as any thing. Do but fall to work lustily and who knows but that rough stone may prove a Pillar in the Temple of God? In the Name of the living God, as you will answer it shortly at his Bar, I command you to be faithful in instructing and catechizing your young ones; if you think I am too peremptory, I pray read the command from my Master himself. Deut. vi. 7. Is not the duty clear? and dare you neglect so direct a Command? Are the Souls of your Children of no value? Are you willing that they should be brands of Hell? Are you indifferent whether they be Damned or Saved? Shall the Devil run away with them without controul? will not you use your utmost endeavour to deliver them from the wrath to come? You see that they are not subjects incapable of the grace of God; whatever you think of them, Christ doth not slight them; they are not too little to die, they are not too little to go to Hell, they are not too little to serve the great Master, too little to go to Heaven; for of such is the Kingdom of God: And will not a possibility of their Conversion and Salvation, put you upon the greatest diligence to teach them? Or are Christ and Heaven and Salvation, small things with you? If they be, then indeed I have done with you? But if they be not, I beseech you lay about you with all your might; the Devil knows your time is going apace, it will shortly be too late. O therefore what you do, do quickly, and do it, I say, with all your might; O pray, pray, pray, and live holy before them, and take some time daily to speak a little to your Children, one by one, about their miserable Condition by nature. I knew a Child that was converted by this sentence

from

To Parents and Teachers, &c.

from a godly School-Mistress in the Country, *Every Mother's Child of you
re by Nature Children of Wrath.* Put your Children upon learning their
catechism, and the Scriptures, and getting to pray and weep by themselves
after Christ: Take heed of their company; take heed of pardoning a lie;
take heed of letting them mispend the Sabbath, put them I beseech you, up-
on imitating these sweet Children; let them read this Book over an hundred
times, and observe how they are affected, and ask them what they think
of those Children, and whether they would not be such? and follow what
you do with earnest cries to God, and be in travail to see Christ formed
in their Souls. I have prayed for you I have oft prayed for your Chil-
dren, and I love them dearly; and I have prayed over these papers; that
God would strike in with them, and make them effectual to the good of their
Souls. Encourage your Children to read this Book and lead them to improve
it. What is presented, is faithfully taken from experienced solid Chris-
tians, some of them no way related to the Children, who themselves were
Eye and Ear witnesses of God's works of Wonder, & from my own knowledge,
or from Reverend Godly Ministers, and from persons that are of unspotted
reputation, for Holiness, Integrity and Wisdom: and several passages are
taken verbatim in writing from their dying Lips, I may add many other
excellent Examples, if I have any encouragement in this Place. That
the Young Generation may be far more excellent than this, is the Prayer
of one that dearly loves little Children.

James Janeway.

The

The P R E F A C E,

Containing Directions to CHILDREN.

YOU may now hear (my dear Lambs) what other good Children have done, and remember how they wept and prayed by themselves; how earnestly they cried out for an Interest in the Lord Jesus Christ: May you not read how dutiful they were to their Parents? how diligent at their Books? how ready to learn the Scriptures and their Catechisms? Can you forget what Questions they were wont to ask? How much they feared a lye, how much they abhorred naughty company, how holy they lived, how dearly they were loved, how joyfully they died?

But tell me, my dear Children and tell me truly, Do you do as these Children did? Did you ever see your miserable state by Nature? Did you ever get by your self and weep for Sin, and pray for grace and pardon? Did you ever go to your Father or Mother, Master or Mistress, and beg of them to pity you, and pray for you, and to teach you what you shall do to be saved? what you shall do to get to Christ, Heaven and Glory? Dost thou love to be taught good things? Come tell me truly, dear Child, for I would fain do what I can possibly to keep you from falling into everlasting Fire. I would fain have thee one of those little ones, which Christ will take into his arms and bless. How dost thou spend thy time? is it in play and Idleness, and with wicked children? Dare you take God's Name in vain, swear or tell a lye? Dare you to do any thing which your Parents forbid you, and neglect to do what they command you? Do you dare run up and down on the Lord's-day? or do you keep in to read your Book, and to learn what your Parents command you? what do you say, Child? Which of these two sorts are you of? Let me talk a little with you, and ask you a few Questions.

1. Were not these Children sweet Children, which feared God and were dutiful to their Parents? Did not their Fathers and Mothers, and every body that fears God, love them, and praise them? What do you think is become of them, now they are dead and gone? Why, they are gone to Heaven, and are singing Hallelujahs with the Angels; they see glorious things, and have nothing but joy and pleasure, they shall never sin any more, they shall never be beat any more, they shall never be sick, or in pain any more.

2. And would not you have your Fathers love, your Mothers commendation; your Master's good word? Would not you have God and Christ love you, and would not you sail go to Heaven when you die; and live with your godly Parents in Glory, and be happy forever?

3. Whither do you think those Children go when they die, that will not do what they are bid, but play the Truant, and speak naughty words, and break the Sabbath? whither do such Children go do you think? Why, I will tell you, they who lie, must go to their Father the Devil, into everlasting burning; they who never pray, God will pour out his wrath upon them; and when they beg and pray in Hell Fire, God will not forgive them; but there they must lie forever.

4. And are you willing to go to Hell to be burned with the Devil and his Angels; Would you be in the same condition as naughty Children? O Hell is a terrible place, that's worse a thousand times than whipping, God's anger is worse than your Father's anger; and are you willing to anger God? O Child, this is most certainly true that all that be wicked, and die so, must be turned into Hell; and if any one be once there, there is no coming out again.

5. Would you not do any thing in the World rather than be thrown into Hell Fire? Would you not do any thing in the world to get Christ, and Grace, and Glory.

6. Well now what will you do? will you read this book a little, because your good Mother will make you do it, and because it is a little new book, but as soon as ever you have done, run away to play, and never think of it.

7. How art thou now affected, poor Child, in the Reading of this book? Have you shed ever a tear since you began reading?

reading? have you been by yourself upon your knees; and begging that God would make you like these blessed Children? Or are you as you use to be, as careless and foolish and disobedient and wicked as ever?

8. Did you never hear of a little Child that died? and if other Children die, why may not you be sick and die? And what will you do then, Child, if you should have no grace in your heart, and be found like other naughty Children?

9. How do you know but you may be the next Child that may die? and where are you then, if you be not God's Child?

10. Wilt thou tarry any longer, my dear Child, before thou run into thy Chamber, and beg of God to give thee a Christ for thy soul, that thou mayest not be undone forever? Wilt thou get presently into a corner to weep and pray? Methinks I see that pretty Lamb begin to weep, and think of getting by himself, and will as well as he can cry unto the Lord, to make him one of those little ones that go into the Kingdom of Heaven: Methinks there stands a sweet Child, and there another, that are resolved for Christ, and for Heaven: Methinks that little Boy looks as if he had a mind to learn good things: Methinks I hear one say, Well, I will never tell a lie more; I will never keep any naughty Boys company more; they will learn me to swear, and to speak naughty words; they do not love God. I'll learn my Catechism, and get my Mother to teach me to pray, and I will go and weep and cry to Christ, and will not be quiet till the Lord hath given me Grace. O that's my brave Child indeed!

11. But will you not quickly forget your promise? are you resolved by the Strength of Christ to be a good Child? Are you indeed? nay but are you indeed? Consider, dear Child, God calls you to remember your Creator in the days of your youth; and he takes it kindly when little ones come to him, and loves them dearly; and godly people, especially Parents and Masters and Mistresses, they have no greater joy, than to see their Children walk in the way of truth.

Now tell me my pretty dear Child, what will you do? shall I make you a Book? shall I pray for you, and intreat you? shall your good Mother weep over you? And will not you make all glad by your turning quickly to the Lord? Shall Christ
tell

tell you that he will love you? And will not you love him? Will you strive to be like those Children? I am perswaded that God intends to do good to the Souls of some little Children by these papers, because he hath laid it so much upon my heart to pray for them and over these papers, and through mercy I have already experienc'd that something of this nature hath not been in vain. I shall give a word of direction, and so leave you.

1. Take heed of what you know is naught; as lying, O that is a greivous fault indeed, and naughty words, and taking the Lord's name in vain, and playing upon the Lord's day, and keeping bad company, and playing with ungodly Children: But if you go to School with such tell them that God will not love them, but that the Devil will have them, if they continue to be so naughty.

2. Do what your Father and Mother bid you chearfully; and take heed of doing any thing that they forbid you.

3. Be diligent in reading the Scripture, and learning your Catechism; and what you do not understand, to be sure ask the meaning of.

4. Think a little sometimes by yourself about God and Heaven, your Soul, and what Christ came into the world for.

5. And if you have no great mind to do thus, but had rather be at play, then think, what is it that makes me not care for good things; is this like one of God's dear Children? I am afraid I am none of God's Child, I feel, I do not love to come unto him: O! What shall I do? Either I will be God's Child or the Devil's; O what shall I do? I would not be the Devil's Child for any thing in the World.

6. Then go to your Father or Mother, or some good Body, and ask them what thou shalt do to be God's Child; and tell them that thou art afraid, and that thou canst not be contented, till thou hast got the love of God.

7. Get by thyself, into the Chamber or Garret, and fall upon thy knees, and weep and mourn, and tell Christ thou art afraid that he doth not love thee, but thou would fain have his love; beg of him to give thee his Grace and pardon for thy sins, and that he would make thee his Child. Tell God thou dost not care who don't love thee, if God will but love

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love thee: Say to him, *Father, hast thou not a blessing for me thy poor Child? Father hast thou not a blessing for me, even for me? O give me a Christ! O give me a Christ! O let me not be undone forever!* Thus beg as for your lives, and be not contented till you have an answer; and do thus every day, with as much earnestness as you can twice a day at least.

8. Give yourself up to Christ: Say, Dear Jesus, thou didst bid that little Children should be suffered to come unto thee; and Lord, I am come as well as I can; I would fain be thy Child; take my Heart and make it humble, and meek, and sensible and obedient; I give myself unto thee, dear Jesus, do what thou wilt with me, so that thou wilt but love me, and give me thy Grace and Glory.

9. Get acquainted with Godly People, and ask them good questions, and endeavour to love their talk.

10. Labour to get a dear love for Christ; read the History of Christ's sufferings: and ask the reason of his sufferings, and never be content till you see your need of Christ, and the excellency and use of Christ.

11. Hear the most powerful Ministers; and read the most searching books, and get your Father to buy you Mr. White's Book for little Children, and, A Guide to Heaven.

12. Resolve to continue in well-doing all your days; then thou shalt be one of those sweet little ones that Christ will take into his arms, and bless, and give a Kingdom, Crown and Glory to. And now, dear Children, I have done, I have written to you, I have prayed for you; but what you will do I can't tell. O Children, if you love me, if you love your Parents, if you love your Souls, if you would escape Hell Fire, and if you would live in Heaven when you die, do you go and do as these good Children; and that you may be your Parents joy, your Country's honour, and live in God's fear, and die in his love, is the prayer of your dear Friend,

James Janeway.



Token for CHILDREN.

EXAMPLE I.

*Of one eminently converted between eight and nine Years old;
with an Account of her Life and Death.*

MISS Sarah Hawley, when she was between eight and nine Years old, was carried by her Friends to hear a Sermon, where the Minister preached upon Mat. xi. 30. *My Yoke is easy, and my Burden is light.* In applying of which Scripture, this Child was mightily awakened, and made deeply sensible of the Condition of her Soul, and her need of a Christ, she wept bitterly to think what a Case she was in; and went Home, and got by herself into a Chamber; and upon her Knees she wept and cry'd to the Lord, as well as she could, which might easily be perceived by her Eyes and Countenance.

2. She was not contented with this, but she got her little Brother and Sister into a Chamber with her, and told them of their Condition by Nature, and wept over them and prayed with them and for them.

3. After this she heard another Sermon from Prov. xxix. 1. He that being often reprov'd, hardneth his Heart, shall suddenly be destroyed, and that without Remedy: At which she was more affected than before, and was so exceeding solicitous about her Soul, that she spent a great Part of the Night in weeping and praying, and could scarce take any

Rest Day and Night for some Time together ; desiring with all her Soul to escape from everlasting Flames, and to get an Interest in the Lord Jesus : O what should she do for a Christ ! what should she do to be saved !

4. She gave her self much to attending upon the Word preached, and still continued very tender under it, greatly favouring what she heard.

5. She was very much in secret Prayer, as might be easily perceived by those who listened at the Chamber Door, and usually very importunate and full of Tears.

6. She could scarce speak of Sin, or be spoke to, but her Heart was ready to melt.

7. She spent much Time in reading the Scripture and a book called, The best Friend in the worst of Times ; by which the Work of God was much promoted upon her Soul, and was much directed by it how to get acquainted with God, especially toward the End of that Book. Another Book she was much delighted with, was Mr. Swinnock's Christian Man's Calling, and by this she was taught in this Measure to make Religion her Business. The Spiritual Bee was a great Companion of hers.

8. She was exceeding dutiful to her Parents, very loth to grieve them in the least ; and if she had at any Time (which was very rare) offended them, she would weep bitterly.

9. She abhorr'd Lying, and allowed herself in no known Sin.

10. She was very Conscientious in spending of Time, and hated Idleness, and spent her whole Time either in praying, reading, or instructing at her Needle, at which she was very ingenious.

11. When she was at School, she was eminent for her Diligence, Teachableness, Meekness and Modesty, speaking little ; but when she did speak, it was usually spiritual.

12. She continued in this Course of religious Duties for some Years together.

13. When she was about fourteen Years old, she broke a Vein in her Lungs (as is supposed) and oft did spit Blood, yet did a little recover again, but had several dangerous Relapses.

14. At the beguining of January last, she was taken very bad again, in which Sickness she was in great Distress of Soul.

When

When she was first taken, she said, O Mother, pray, pray, pray for me, for Satan is so busy that I cannot pray for myself; I see I am undone without a Christ, and a Pardon ! O I am undone to all Eternity !

15. Her Mother knowing how serious she had been formerly, did a little wonder that she should be in such agonies; Upon which her Mother asked her, What sin it was that was so burdensome to her Spirit ? O Mother, said she, It is not any particular Sin of Omission or Commission, that sticks so close to my conscience, as the Sin of my Nature; without the Blood of Christ that will damn me.

16. Her Mother asked her what she should pray for, for her, she answered, that I may have a saving Knowledge of Sin and Christ, and that I may have an Assurance of God's Love to my Soul. Her Mother asked her, Why she did speak so little to the Minister that came to her ? She answered, That it was her Duty with Patience and Silence to learn of them: and it was exceeding painful to her to speak to any.

17. One Time when she fell into a fit she cried out, O I am going, I am going : But what shall I do to be saved ? Sweet Lord Jesus, I will lie at thy Feet ; and if I perish it shall be at the Fountain of thy Mercy.

18. She was much afraid of Presumption, and dreaded a Mistake in the Matters of her Soul, and would be often putting up Ejaculations to God, to deliver her from deceiving herself. To instance in one : Great and mighty God, give me Faith: and true faith : Lord that I may not be a foolish Virgin having a Lamp and no Oil.

19. She would be many Times laying hold on the Promises, and plead them in Prayer That in Mat. xi. 28, 29. was much on her Tongue and no small Relief to her Spirit. How many Times would she cry out, Lord, Hast thou not said, Come unto me all ye that are weary and heavy laden, and I will give you rest.

20. Another Time her Father bid her be of good Cheer, because she was going to a better Father : At which she fell into a great Passion, and said, But how do I know that ? I am a poor Sinner that wants Assurance, O for Assurance ! It was still her Note, O for Assurance ! This was her great

earnest and constant Request, to all that came to her, to beg Assurance for her ! And poor Heart, she would look with so much eagerness upon them, as if she desired nothing in the World so much as that they would pity her, and help her with their Prayers ; never was poor Creature more earnest for any Thing, than she was for Assurance, and the Light of God's Countenance : O the piteous Moans that she would make ! O the Agonies that her Soul was in !

21. Her mother ask'd her if God would spare her Life, how she would live ? Truly Mother, said she, We have such base Hearts, that I can't tell. We are apt to promise great Thing when we are sick, but when we are recovered we are as ready to forget ourselves and to return again unto Folly ; but I hope I shall be more careful of my Time and my Soul than I have been.

22. She was full of natural Affection to her Parents, and very careful lest her Mother should be tired out with much watching. Her Mother said, How shall I bear parting with thee, when I have scarce dried my eyes for thy Brother ! She answered, The God of Love support and comfort you : It is but a little while, and we shall meet, I hope in Glory. She being very weak could speak but little, therefore her Mother said, Child, if thou hast any Comfort lift up thine Hand ; which she did.

23. The Lord's Day before that on which she died, a Kinsman of her's came to see her, and asking of her whether she knew him ? she replied, Yea, I know you, and I desire you would learn to know Christ ; you are young, but you know not how soon you may die : And O to die without Christ, is a fearful Thing : O redeem Time ! O Time, Time, Time, precious Time ! Being requested by him not to speak for her self, she said, She would do all the good she could while she lived, and when she was dead too, as possible : Upon which account, she desired a Sermon might be preached at her Funeral, concerning the Preciousness of Time. O that young Ones would now remember their Creator !

24. Some Ministers that came to her, did with Earnestness beg that the Lord would please to give her some Token of Good, that she might go off triumphing ; and Bills of the same Nature were sent to several Churches.

25. After

25. After she had long waited for an Answer of their Prayers, she said, Well, I will venture my Soul upon Christ.

26. She carried it with wonderful Patience, and yet would often pray that the Lord would give her more Patience; which he answered to Astonishment; for considering the Pains and Agonies she was in, her Patience was next to a wonder; Lord, Lord, give me Patience, said she, that I may not dishonour thee.

27. Upon Thursday, after long waiting, great Fears, and many Prayers, when all her Friends thought she had been past speaking, to the Astonishment of her Friends, she broke forth thus with a very audible Voice, and chearful Countenance; Lord, thou hast promised, that whosoever cometh unto Thee, thou wilt in no wise cast out; Lord I come unto Thee; and surely thou wilt in no wise cast me out. O so sweet! O so glorious is Jesus! O I have the sweet and glorious Jesus; He is sweet, He is sweet! O the admirable Love of God in sending Christ! O free Grace to a poor lost Creature! And thus she ran on repeating many of these Things an hundred Times, but her Friends were so astonished to see her in this divine Rapture, and to hear such gracious Words, and her Prayers and Desires satisfied, that they could not write a quarter of what she spoke.

28. When her soul was thus ravished with the Love of Christ, and her Tongue so highly engaged in magnifying God; her Father, Brethren, and Sisters, with others of the Family, were called, to whom she spake particularly, as her Strength would allow. She gave her Bible as a Legacy to one of her Brothers, and desired him to use it well for her sake, and added to him, and the rest, O make Use of Time to get a Christ for your Souls; spend no Time in running up and down in playing: O get a Christ for your Souls while you are Young: Remember now your Creator before you come to a sick Bed: Put not off this great work 'till then, for then you will find it a hard Work indeed. I know by experience, the Devil will tell you it is enough; and ye are Young, what need you to be in such haste? You will have Time enough when you are old: But there stands one (meaning her Grandmother) that stays behind, and I that am but Young am going.

going before her. Therefore make your Calling and Election sure, while you are in Health. But I am afraid this will be but one Night's Trouble to your Thoughts; but remember, these are the Words of your dying Sister. O, if you knew how good Christ were! O if you had but one Taste of his Sweetness, you would rather go to Him a thousand times than stay in this wicked World. I would not for ten Thousand, and ten Thousand Worlds part with my Interest in Christ. O how happy am I, that I am going to everlasting Joys! I would not go back again for twenty Thousand Worlds; and will you not strive to get an Interest in Christ?

29. After this, looking upon one of her Father's Servants, she said, What shall I do? What shall I do at that great Day, when Christ shall say to me, Come thou blessed of my Father, inherit the Kingdom prepared for thee: And shall say to the Wicked, Go thou cursed into the Lake that burns for ever. What a grief is it for me to think, that I shall see any of my Friends that I knew here upon Earth, turned into that Lake that burns forever! O that Word, For ever, remember that, For ever! I speak these Words to you, but they are nothing, except God speak to you too: O pray, pray, pray, that God would give you Grace! And then she pray'd, O Lord finish thy Work upon their Souls. It will be my Comfort (said she) to see you in Glory, but it will be your everlasting Happiness.

30. Her Grandmother told her she had spent herself too much; she said, I care not for that, if I could do any Soul good. O with what Vehemency did she speak, as if her Heart were in every Word she spoke.

31. She was full of divine Sentences; almost all her Discourse, from the first to the last in the Time of her Sickness, was about her Soul, Christ's Sweetness, and the Souls of others; in a word, like a continued Sermon.

32. Upon Friday, after she had such lively Discoveries of God's Love, she was exceeding desirous to die, and cried out Come Lord Jesus, come quickly, conduct me to thy Tabernacle; I am a poor Creature without Thee; but Lord Jesus, my Soul longs to be with Thee: O when shall it be! Why not now, dear Jesus? Come Lord Jesus, come quickly,
but

but why do I speak thus? Thy Time, dear Lord, is the best ;
O give me Patience !

33 Upon Saturday she spoke very little (being very drowsy)
yet now and then dropt these Words, How long sweet Jesus?
Finish thy Work sweet Jesus: Come away dear sweet Lord
Jesus, come quickly: Sweet Lord help, come away, now, now,
dear Jesus, come quickly: Good Lord, give Patience to me
to wait thine appointed Time: Lord Jesus help me, help me.
Thus at several Times (when out of her sleep) for she was
asleep the greatest part of the Day.

34. Upon the Lord's Day, she scarce spoke any thing but
much desired that Bills of Thanksgiving might be sent to those
who had formerly been praying for her, that they might help
her to praise God for that full Assurance that he had given
her of his Love: and seemed to be much swallowed up with
the thoughts of God's free Love to her Soul. She oft
commended her spirit into the Lord's Hands; and the last
words she was heard to speak, were these, Lord help, Lord
Jesus help; Dear Lord Jesus; blessed Jesus—And thus up-
on the Lord's Day between Nine and Ten of the Clock in
the Forenoon, she slept sweetly in Jesus, and began an ever-
lasting Sabbath, February 19. 1670.

EXAMPLE II.

*Of a Child that was admirably affected with the Things of
GOD. when he was between two and three Years old,
with a brief Account of his Life and Death.*

1. **A** Certain little Child, whose Mother had dedicated
him to the Lord in her Womb, when he could not
speak plain, would be crying after God, and was greatly de-
sireous to be taught good Things.

2. He could not endure to be put to Bed without Family
Duty, but would put his Parents upon Duty, and would with
much Devotion, kneel down, and with great Patience and
Delight continue 'till Duty was at an End, without the least
Expression of being weary; and he seemed never so well pleased
as when he was engaged in Duty.

3. He could not be satisfied with Family Duty, but he would
be oft upon his Knees by himself in one Corner or other.

4. He was much delighted in hearing the Word of God, either read or preached.

5. He loved to go to School, that he might learn something of God, and would observe and take great Notice of what he had read, and come Home and speak of it with much Affection; and he would rejoice in his Book, and say to his Mother, O Mother! I have had a sweet Lesson to Day, will you be pleased to give me leave to fetch my Book that you may hear it?

6. As he grew up, he was more and more affected with the Things of another World; so that if we had not received our Information from one that is of undoubted Fidelity, it would seem incredible.

7. He quickly learned to read the Scripture, and with great Reverence, Tendernefs and Groans, read 'till Tears and Sobs were ready to hinder him.

8. When he was at secret Prayer, he would weep bitterly.

9. He was wont oftentimes to complain of the Naughtiness of his Heart, and seemed to be more grieved for the Corruption of his Nature than for actual Sin.

10. He had a vast Understanding in the Things of God, even next to a Wonder, for one of his Age.

11. He was much troubled for the Wandering of his Thoughts in Duty, and that he could not keep his Heart always fixed upon God and the Work he was about, and his Affections constantly raised.

12. He kept a Watch over his Heart, and observed the Working of his Soul, and would complain that they were so vain and foolish, and so little busied about spiritual Things.

13. As he grew up, he grew daily in Knowledge and Experience, and his Carriage was so heavenly, and his Discourse so excellent and experimental, that it made those who heard it astonished.

14. He was exceeding importunate with God in Duty, and would plead with God at a strange Rate; and would use such Arguments in Prayer, that one would think it were impossible should ever enter into the Heart of a Child: And he would beg and expostulate, and weep so, that sometimes it could not be kept from the Ears of Neighbours; so that one of the next

House

House was forced to cry out, *The Prayers and Tears of that Child in the next House will sink me to Hell!* Because by it he did condemn his Neglect of Prayer, and his slight Performance of it.

15. He was very fearful of wicked Company, and would often beg of God to keep him from it, and that he might never be pleased with them that took Delight in displeasing of God: And when he was at any Time in the hearing of their wicked Words, taking the Lord's Name in vain, or swearing, or any filthy Words, it would even make him tremble, and ready to go home and weep.

16. He abhorred Lying with his Soul.

17. When he had committed any Sin he was easily convinced of it, and would get in some Corner and secret Place, and with Tears beg Pardon of God, and Strength against such a Sin. He had a Friend that oft watched him, and listened at his Chamber Door, from whom I received this Narrative.

18. When he had been asked, whether he would commit such a Sin again, he would never promise absolutely, because, he said, his Heart was naught; but he would weep and say, he hoped by the Grace of God he should not.

19. When he was left alone upon the Sabbath-Days, he would be sure not to spend any Part of the Day in Idleness and Play, but be busied in praying, reading in the Bible, and getting of his Catechism.

20. When other Children were playing, he would many a time and oft be praying.

21. One Day a certain Person was discoursing with him about the Nature, Offices, and Excellency of Christ, and that He alone can satisfy for our Sins, and merit everlasting Life for us; and about other of the great Mysteries of Redemption; he seemed savingly to understand them, and greatly delighted with the Discourse.

22. One speaking concerning the Resurrection of the Body, he did acknowledge it; but that the same weak Body that was buried in the Church Yard should be raised again, he thought very strange, but with admiration yielded, that nothing was impossible with God; and that very Day he was taken sick unto Death.

23. A Friend of his asked him, Whether he was willing to die, when he was first taken sick : He answered, No ; Because he was afraid of his State as to another World : Why Child, said the other, Thou didst pray for a new Heart, for an humble and sincere Heart. and I have heard thee ; didst thou not pray with thy Heart ? He said, I hope I did.

24. Not long after, the same Person asked him again, whether he was willing to die ? He answered, Now I am willing, for I shall go to Christ.

25 One asked him, What would become of his Sister, if he should die and leave her ? He answered, the Will of the Lord must be done.

26 He still grew weaker and weaker, but carried it with a great deal of Sweetness and Patience, waiting for his Change, and at last did chearfully commit his Spirit unto the Lord ; and calling upon the Name of the Lord, and saying, Lord Jesus, Lord Jesus,—in whose Bosom, he sweetly slept, dying as I remember, when he was about five or six Years old.

EXAMPLE III.

Of a little Girl that was wrought upon, when she was between four and five Years old, with some Account of her holy Life, and triumphant Death.

1. **M**ARY, when she was between four and five Years old, was greatly affected in hearing the Word of God, and became very solicitous about her Soul, and everlasting Condition, weeping bitterly to think what would become of her in another World, asking strange Questions concerning God and Christ. and her own Soul. So that this little Mary, before she was five Years old, seemed to mind The one Thing needful, and to choose, The better Part, and sat at the Feet of Christ many a Time, and oft with Tears.

2. She was wont to be much in secret Duty, and many times come off from her Knees with Tears

3. She would chuse such Times and Places for secret Duty as might render her less observed by others, and did endeavour what possibly she could to conceal what she was doing when engaged in secret Duty.

4. She

4. She was greatly afraid of Hypocrisy, and of doing any Thing to be seen of Men, and to get Commendation and Praise; and when she heard one of her Brothers saying, That he had been by himself at Prayer, she rebuked him sharply, and told him how little such Prayers were like to profit him, and that it was but little to his Praise, to pray like a Hypocrite, and to be glad that any should know what he had been doing.

5. Her Mother being full of Sorrow after the Death of her Husband, this Child came to her Mother, and ask'd her Why she wept so exceedingly? Her Mother answered, She had cause enough to weep, because her Father was dead: No, dear Mother, said the Child, you have no cause to weep so much; for God is a good God still to you.

6. She was a dear lover of faithful Ministers. One time after she had been hearing of Mr. Whitaker, she said, I love that Man dearly, for the sweet Words he speaks about Christ.

7. Her Book was her Delight, and what she did read, she loved to make her own, and cared not for passing over what she learned, without extraordinary Observation and Understanding; and many times she was so strangely affected in reading of the Scriptures, that she would burst out into Tears, and would hardly be pacified; so greatly was she taken with Christ's sufferings, the Zeal of God's Servants, and the danger of a natural State.

8. She would complain oftentimes of the Corruption of her Nature, of the Hardness of her Heart, that she could repeat no more thoroughly, and be no more humble and grieved for her Sins against a good God; and when she did thus complain, it was with abundance of Tears.

9. She was greatly concerned for the Souls of others, and grieved to think of the miserable Condition they were in upon that Account: When she could handsomely, she would be putting in some pretty sweet Word of Christ; but above all, she would do what she could to draw the Hearts of her Brethren and Sisters after Christ; and there was no small hopes that her example and good counsel did prevail with some of them when they were very young, to get into Corners to pray, and to ask very gracious Questions about the Things of God.

10. She was very conscientious in keeping the Sabbath, spending the whole time either in reading, praying, or learning her

her Catechism, or in teaching her Brethren and Sisters. One time when she was left at Home upon the Lord's Day, she got some other little Children together, with her Brothers and Sisters, and instead of playing (as other naughty Children use to do) she told them, That was the Lord's Day, and that they ought to remember that Day to keep it holy : And then she told them, how it was to be spent in religious exercises all the Day long, except so much as was to be taken up in the Works of Necessity and Mercy ; then she prayed with them herself, and among other Things begged that the Lord would give Grace and Wisdom to them little Children, that they might know how to serve him ; as one of the little Ones in the Company with her, told afterwards.

11. She was a Child of a strange Tendernefs and Compassion to all, full of Bowels and Pity : Whom she could not help, she would be ready to weep over ; especially if she saw her Mother at any time troubled, she would quickly make her Sorrows her own, and weep for her and with her.

12. When her Mother had been somewhat solicitous about any worldly Thing, she would, if she could, put her off from her Care one Way or other. One Time she told her, O Mother, Grace is better than that (meaning something her Mother wanted) I had rather have Grace and the Love of Christ, than any Thing in the World.

13. This Child was often musing and busied in the thoughts of her everlasting Work ; witness that strange Question, O what are they doing, who are already in Heaven ? And she seem'd greatly desirous to be among them who were praising, loving, delighting in God, and serving of Him without Sin. Her Language was so strange about spiritual Matters, that she made many excellent Christians to stand amazed, as judging it scarce to be parallel'd.

14. She took great Delight in reading of the Scriptures, and some Part of it was more sweet to her than her appointed Food : She would get several choice Scriptures by Heart, and discourse of them favourly, and apply them suitably.

15. She was not altogether a Stranger to other good Books, but would be reading of them with much Affection : and where she might, she noted the Books particularly, observing what in the reading did most warm her Heart, and she was ready upon Occasion to improve it.

16. One

16. One Time, a Woman coming into the House in a great Passion, spoke of her Condition as if none were like hers, and it would never be otherwise; the Child said, It were a strange Thing to say, when it is Night, it will never be Day.

17. At another Time, a near Relation of her's being in some Streights, made some complaint; to whom she said, I have heard Mr. Carter say, a Man may go to Heaven without a Penny in his Purse, but not without Grace in his Heart.

18. She had an extraordinary Love to the People of God; and when she saw any that she thought feared the Lord, her Heart would even leap for Joy.

19. She loved to be much by herself, and would be greatly grieved if she were at any Time deprived of a Conveniency for secret Duty; she could not live without constant Address to God in secret; and was not a little pleased when she could go into a Corner to pray and weep.

20. She was much in praising God, and seldom or never complained of any thing but Sin.

21. She continued in this Course of praying and praising of God, and great Dutifulness and Sweetness to her Parents and those that taught her any Thing; yea, she did greatly encourage her Mother while she was a Widow, and desired that the Absence an Husband might in some Measure be made up by the Dutifulness and Holiness of a Child. She studied all the Ways that could be to make her Mother's Life sweet.

22. When she was between eleven and twelve Years old, she sickned; in which she carried it with admirable Patience and Sweetness, and did what she could, with Scripture Arguments, to support and encourage her Relations to part with her, who was going to Glory, and to prepare themselves to meet her in a blessed Eternity.

23. She was not many Days sick before she was marked; which she first saw herself, and was greatly rejoiced to think that she was marked out for the Lord, and was now going apace to Christ. She called to her Friends, and said, I am marked; but be not troubled, for I know that I am marked for one of the Lord's own. One asked her, How she knew that? She answered, The Lord hath told me, that I am one of his dear Children. And thus she spoke with a holy Confidence in the Lord's Love to her Soul, and was not in the least daunted when she

the Spake of her Death; but seemed greatly delighted in the Apprehension of her Nearness to her Father's House; and it was not long before she was fill'd with Joy unspeakable in believing.

24. When she just lay a dying, her Mother came to her and told her, She was sorry that she had reproved and corrected so good a Child so oft. O Mother, said she, Speak not thus: I bless God, now I am a dying, for your Reproofs and Corrections too, for it may be, I might have gone to Hell, if it had not been for your Reproofs and Corrections.

25. Some of her Neighbours coming to visit her, asked her If she would leave them? She answered them, If you serve the Lord, you shall come after me to Glory.

26. A little before she died, she had a great Conflict with Satan, and cried out, I am none of his. Her Mother seeing her in Trouble, asked her what was the Matter? She answered, Satan did trouble her, but now, I thank God, all is well, I know I am not his, but Christ's.

27. After this, she had a great Sense of God's Love, and a glorious Sight, as if she had seen the very Heavens opened, and the Angels come to receive her; by which her Heart was filled with Joy, and her Tongue with Praise.

28. Being desired by the Standers by to give them a particular Account of what she saw, she answered, You shall know hereafter; and so in an Extasy of Joy and holy Triumph, she went to Heaven, when she was about twelve Years old —

EXAMPLE IV.

Of a Child that began to look towards Heaven when she was about Four Years old; with some observable Passages in her Life, and at her Death.

1. **A** Certain little Child, when she was about four Years old, had a conscientious Sense of her Duty towards her Parents, because the Commandment saith, *Honour thy Father and thy Mother*: And though she had little Advantage of Education, she carried it with the greatest Reverence to her Parents imaginable, so that she was no small Credit, as well as Comfort to them.

2. It was no unusual Thing for her to weep, if she saw her Parents troubled, tho' herself had not been the Occasion of it.

3. When

3. When she came from School, she would with Grief and Abhorrence say, That other Children had sinned against God by speaking grievous Words, which were so bad that she durst not speak them again.

4. She would be oftentimes admiring of God's Mercy, for so much Goodness to her rather than to others; that she saw some begging, others blind, some crooked, and that she wanted nothing that was good for her.

5. She was many a Time, and often, in one Hole or another, in Tears, upon her Knees.

6. This poor little Thing would be ready to counsel other little Children, how they ought to serve God? and putting them upon getting by themselves to pray; and hath been known, when her Friends have been abroad, to have been teaching Children to pray, especially upon the Lord's-Day.

7. She very seriously begged the Prayers of others, that they would remember her, that the Lord would give her Grace.

8. When this Child saw some that were Laughing who she judged to be very Wicked; she told them, She feared they had little Reason to be merry. They asked, Whether one might not laugh? she answered; No indeed, 'till you have Grace! They who are Wicked, have more need to cry than to laugh.

9. She would say, That it was the Duty of Parents, Masters and Mistresses, to reprove (those under their Charge) for Sin, or else God will meet with them.

10. She would be very attentive when she read the Scriptures, and be much affected with them.

11. She would by no Means be persuaded to prophane the Lord's Day, but would spend it in some good Duties.

12. When she went to School, it was willingly and joyfully, and she was very teachable and exemplary to other Children.

13. When she was taken sick, one asked her, Whether she were willing to die? She answered, Yes, if God would pardon her Sins. Being asked, How her Sins would be pardoned? She answered, Through the Blood of Christ.

14. She said, She did believe in Christ, and desired and longed to be with Him; and did with a great deal of Chearfulness give up her Soul.

There were very many observable Passages in the Life and Death of this Child, but the Hurry and Grief her Friends were in buried them.

EXAMPLE V.

Of the pious Life and joyful Death of a Child who died when he was about 12 Years old, 1632.

1. **C**harles Bridgham had no sooner learnt to speak, but he betook himself to Prayer.

2. He was very prone to learn the Things of God.

3. He would be sometimes teaching them their Duty that waited upon him.

4. He learned by heart many good Things, before he was well fit to go to School: And when he was sent to School, he carried it so, that all who observed him, either did or might admire him. O the sweet Nature, the good Disposition, the sincere Religion, which was in this Child!

5. When he was at School, what was it that he desired to learn, but Christ, and him crucified?

6. So religious and savoury were his Words, his Actions so upright, his Devotion so hearty, his fear of God so great, that many were ready to say, as they did of *John*, What Manner of Child shall this be?

7. He would be much in reading the holy Scriptures.

8. He was desirous of more spiritual Knowledge, and would be often asking very serious and admirable Questions.

9. He would not stir out of Doors before he had poured out his Soul to the Lord.

10. When he eat any Thing, he would be sure to lift up his Heart to the Lord for a Blessing upon it; and when he had moderately refreshed himself by eating, he would not forget to acknowledge God's Goodness in feeding of him.

11. He would not lie down in his Bed, 'till he had been upon his Knees; and when sometimes he had forgotten his Duty, he would quickly rise out of his Bed, and kneeling down upon his bare knees, covered with no Garment but his Linens, ask God Forgiveness for that Sin.

12. He would rebuke his Brethren if they were at any Times too hasty at their Meals, and did eat without asking a Blessing; his Check was usually thus; Dare you do thus? God be merciful to us, this bit of Bread might choak us.

13. His Sentences were wise and weighty, and well might become some ancient Christian.

14. His

14. His Sicknefs was a lingering Difeafe, againft which to comfort him, one tells him of Poffeffions that muft fall to his Portion : And what are they (faid he) I had rather have the Kingdom of Heaven than a Thoufand fuch Inheritances.

15. When he was fick he feemed much taken up with Heaven, and asked very ferious Queftions about the Nature of his Soul.

16. After he was pretty well fatisfied about that, He enquired how his Soul might be faved ? The anfwer being made, by applying of Chrifts Merits by faith ; he was pleafed with the Anfwer and was ready to give any one that fhould defire it, an account of his Hope.

17. Being asked, whether he had rather live or die ? He anfwered, I defire to die, that I may go to my Saviour.

18. His Pains encreasing upon him, one ask'd him, Whether he would rather ftill endure thofe Pains, or forfake Chrifft ? Alas, faid he, I know not what to fay, being but a Child ; for thefe Pains may ftagger a ftrong Man ; but I will ftrove to endure the beft I can. Upon this he called to mind that Martyr *Thomas Bilney* ; who being in Prifon, the Night before his burning, put his Finger into the Candle, to know how he could endure the Fire. O (faid the Child) had I lived then, I would have run through the Fire to have gone to Chrifft.

19. His Sicknefs lafted long, and at leaft three Days before his Death, he prophesied his Departure, and not only that he muft die, but the very Day. On the Lord's Day, faid he, look to me ; neither was this a word of Courfe, which you may guefs by his often Repetition, every Day asking 'till the Day came indeed, What, is Sunday come ? At laft, the look'd-for Day came indeed, and no fooner had the Sun beautified that Morning with it's Light, but he falls into a Trance : his Eyes were fixed, his Face chearful, his Lips fmiling, his Hands and Feet clafped in a Bow, as if he would have received fome bleffed Angel that were at hand to receive his Soul. But he comes to himfelf and tells them how he faw the fweeteft Body that ever Eyes beheld, who bid him be of good Cheer, for he muft prefently go with him.

20. One that ftood near him, as now fufpecting the Time of his Diffolution nigh, bid him fay, Lord, into thy Hands I commend my Spirit, which is thy due ; for why, thou haft redeemed it, O Lord, my God moft true.

21. The last Words which he spake, were exactly these : Pray, pray, pray, nay, yet pray; and the more Prayers, the better, all prospers; God is the best Physician; into his Hands I commend my Spirit. O Lord Jesus receive my Soul; Now close mine Eyes; Forgive me Father, Mother, Brother, Sister, all the World. Now I am well, my Pain is almost gone, my Joy is at Hand. Lord have Mercy on me, O Lord receive my Soul unto thee. And thus he yielded his Spirit up unto the Lord when he was about Twelve Years old.

This Narrative was taken out of Mr. AMBROSE's Life's Lease.

E X A M P L E VI.

Of a poor Child that was awakened when he was about Five Years old.

1. **A** Certain poor Child that had a very bad Father, but it is to be hoped a very good Mother, was by the Providence of God brought to the Sight of a godly Friend of mine, who upon the first Sight of the Child, had a great Pity for him, and took an Affection for him, and had a Mind to bring him up for Christ.

2. At the first, he did with great Sweetness and Kindness allure the Child; by which Means it was not long before he got a deep Interest in the Heart of the Child, and he began to obey him with more Readiness than Children usually do their Parents.

3. By this a Door was opened for a farther Work, and he had a greater Advantage to instil spiritual Principles into the Soul of the Child, which he was not wanting in, as the Lord gave Opportunity, and the Child was capable of.

4. It was not long before the Lord was pleased to strike in with the spiritual Exhortations of this good Man, so that the Child was brought to a Liking of the Things of God.

5. He quickly learnt a great Part of the Assembly's Catechism by Heart and that before he could read his Primer within Book; and he took a great Delight in learning his Catechism.

6. He was not only able to give a very good Account of his Catechism, but he would answer such Questions as are not in the Catechism, with greater Understanding than could be expected from one of his Age.

7. He took great Delight in discoursing of the Things of God; and when my Friend had been either praying or reading, expounding

expounding or repeating of Sermons, he seemed very attentive, and ready to receive the Truths of God, and would with incredible Gravity, Diligence and Affection, wait 'till Duties were ended, to the no small Joy and admiration of those who observed him.

8. He would ask very excellent Questions, and discourse about the Condition of his Soul and heavenly Things, and seemed mightily concerned what would become of his Soul when he should die : So that his Discourse made some Christians even stand astonished.

9. He was greatly taken with the great Kindness of Christ in dying for Sinners, and would be often in Tears at the mention of it : and seemed at a strange Rate to be affected with the unspeakable Love of Christ.

10. When no Body had been speaking to him, he would burst out into Tears, and being asked the Reason, he would say, That the very Thoughts of Christ's Love to Sinners in suffering for them, made him, that he could not but cry.

11. Before he was 6 Years old he made conscience of secret Duty ; and when he pray'd, it was with such extraordinary Meltings, that his Eyes have looked red and sore with weeping by himself for his Sin.

12. He would be putting of Christians upon spiritual Discourse when he saw them, and seemed little satisfied, unless they were talking of good Things.

13. It is evident, that this poor Child's Thoughts were very much busied about the Things of another World, for he would oftentimes be speaking to his Bed-fellow at midnight about the Matters of his Soul ; and when he could not sleep, he would take heavenly Conference to be sweeter than his appointed rest. This was his usual custom, and thus he would provoke and put forward an experienced Christian, to spend waking Hours in talking of God and the everlasting Rest.

14. Not long after this, his good Mother died, which went very near his Heart, for he greatly honoured his Mother.

15. After the Death of his Mother, he would often repeat some of the promises that are made to fatherless Children, especially that in *Exod xxii. 22.* Ye shall not afflict any Widow, or the fatherless Child, if thou afflict them in any wise, and they cry at all unto me I will surely hear their Cry. —

These Word he would often repeat with Tears, and say, I am Fatherless and Motherless upon Earth, yet if any wrong me, I have a Father in Heaven who will take my Part; to Him I commit my self, and in Him is all my Trust.

16 Thus he continued in a Course of holy Duties, living in the Fear of God, and shewed wonderful Grace for a Child, and died sweetly in the Faith of Jesus.

My Friend is a judicious Christian of many Years Experience, who was no ways related to him, but a constant Eye and Ear Witness of his godly Life, and honourable and cheerful Death, from whom I received this Information.

EXAMPLE VII.

Of a notorious wicked Child, who was taken up from Begging and admirably converted; with an Account of his holy Life and joyful Death, when he was nine Years old.

1. **A** Very poor Child of the Parish of Newington-Butts, came begging to the Door of a dear Christian Friend of mine, in a very lamentable case, so filthy and nasty, that he would have even turned one's Stomach to have looked on him: But it pleased God to raise in the Heart of my Friend, a great Pity and Tenderness towards this poor Child, so that in charity he took him out of the Streets, whose Parents were unknown; and who had nothing at all to commend him to any one's Charity, but his Misery. My Friend eying the Glory of God, and the good of the immortal Soul of this wretched Creature, discharged the Parish of the Child, and took him as his own, designing to bring him up for the Lord Christ. A noble Piece of Charity! And what did make the Kindness far the greater, was that there seemed to be very little Hopes of doing Good upon this Child. for he was a very Monster of Wickedness, and a thousand Times more miserable and vile by his Sin, than by his Poverty. He was running to Hell as soon as he could go, and was old in Naughtiness, when he was young in Years; and one shall scarce hear of a Person so like the Devil in his Infancy, as this poor Child was. What Sin was there (his Age was capable of) that he did not commit? What by the Corruption of his Nature, and the abominable Example of other Boys, he was arrived to a strange Pitch of Impiety. He would call filthy Names, take God's Name in vain, Curse and Swear, and do all Kind of Mischief; and as to any Thing of God, worse than an Heathen.

2. But this Sin and Misery was but a stronger Motive to that gracious Man to pity him, and to do all that possibly he could to pluck this Fire-brand out of the Fire; and it was not long before the Lord was pleased to let him understand, that he had a Design of everlasting Kindness upon the Soul of his poor Child; for no sooner had this good Man taken his Creature into his House, but he prays for him, and labours with all his might to convince him of his miserable Condition by Nature, and to teach him something of God, the Worth of his own Soul, and that Eternity of Glory or Misery that he was born to: And blessed be free Grace, it was not long before the Lord was pleased to let him understand that it was himself which put it into his Heart to take in this Child, that he might bring him up for Christ. The Lord soon struck in with his godly Instructions so that an amazing Change was seen in the Child; in a few Weeks Time he was convinc'd of the Evil of his Ways; no more News now of his calling of Names, Swearing or Cursing; no more taking of the Lord's Name in vain; now he is civil and respectful, and such a strange Alteration was wrought in the Child, that all the Parish that rung of his Villany before, was now ready to talk of his Reformation; his Company, his Talk, his Employment is now changed, and he is like another Creature; so that the Glory of God's free Grace began already to shine in him.

3. And this Change was not only on external-one, and to be discerned Abroad, but he would get by himself, and weep and mourn bitterly, for his horrible wicked Life, as might easily be perceiv'd by them that lived in the House with him.

4. It was the great care of his godly Master to strike in with those Convictions which the Lord had made, and to improve them all he could; and was not a little glad to see that his Labour was not in vain in the Lord: He still experiences that the Lord doth carry on his Work mightily upon the Heart of the Child: He is still more and more broken under a Sense of his undone State by Nature: He is oft in Tears, and bemoaning his lost and miserable condition. When his Master did speak of the Things of God, he listened earnestly, and took in with much greediness and affection what he taught. Seldom was there any Discourse about Soul Matters in his hearing, but he heard it as if it were for his Life, and wept greatly.

5. He

5. He would, after his Master had been speaking to him, or others, of the Things of God, go to him, and question with him about them, and beg of him to instruct and teach him further, and to tell him those things again, that he might remember and understand them better.

6 Thus he continued seeking after the Knowledge of God and Christ, and practising his Duties, till the Sickneſs came into the Houſe, with which the Child was ſmitten. At his firſt ſickning, the poor Child was greatly amazed and afraid, and though his Pains were great, and the Diſtemper very tedious, yet the Senſe of his Sin, and the Thoughts of the miſerable condition that he feared his Soul was in, made his Trouble ten times greater; He was in grievous Agonies of Spirit, and his former Sins ſtared him in the Face, and made him tremble; the Poiſon of God's Arrows did even drink up his Spirits; the Senſe of Sin and Wrath was ſo great, that he could not tell what in the World to do; the Weight of God's Diſpleaſure, and the Thought of lying under it to all Eternity, did even break him to Pieces, and he did cry out very bitterly, What could he do? He was a miſerable Sinner, and he feared he ſhould go to Hell; his Sins had been ſo great and ſo many, that there was no Hopes for him. He was not by far ſo much concerned for his Life, as for his Soul, what would become of that forever. Now the Plague upon his Body ſeemed nothing to that which was in his Soul.

7. But in this great Diſtreſs the Lord was pleaſed to ſend one to take care of his Soul, who uſed to him the great and precious Promiſes which were made to one in his condition; telling him, There was enough in Chriſt for the chiefſt of Sinners; and, that He came to ſeek and to ſave ſuch a loſt Creature as he was. But this poor Child found it a very difficult Thing for him to believe that there was any Mercy for ſuch a dreadful Sinner as he had been.

8. He was made to cry out of himſelf, not only for his Swearing and Lying, and other untowardly notorious Sins; but he was in great Horror for the Sin of his Nature, for the Vileness of his Heart, and original Corruption; under it he was in ſo great Anguiſh, that the Trouble of his Spirit made him in a great meaſure forget the Pains of his Body.

9. He

9. He did very particularly confess and bewail his Sins with Tears; and some Sins so secret that none in the World could charge him with.

10. He would condemn himself for Sin, as deserving no Mercy; and thought there was not a greater Sinner in London than himself, abhorring himself as the vilest creature he knew.

11. He did not only pray much with strong Cries and Tears himself, but he begged the Prayers of Christians for him.

12. He would ask Christians, whether they thought there were any Hopes for him, and would beg of them to deal plainly with him, for he was greatly afraid of being deceived.

13. Being informed how willing and ready the Lord Christ was to accept of poor Sinners, upon their Repentance and Turning, and being counselled to venture himself upon Christ for Mercy and Salvation, he said, I would fain cast myself upon Christ, but he could not but wonder, how Christ should be willing to die for such a vile Wretch as he was; and, that he found it one of the hardest Things in the World to believe.

14. But at last it pleased the Lord to give him some small Hopes that there might be Mercy for him, for he had been the chiefest of Sinners; and was made to lay a little hold on such Promises as that, *Come unto me, all ye that are weary and heavy laden, and I will give you Rest.* But O! how did this poor Boy admire and bless God for the least Hopes! How highly did he advance free and rich Grace, that should pity and pardon him! And at last he was full of Praise, and admiring of God; so that (to speak in the Words of a precious Man, who was an Eye and Ear-Witness) "to the praise and Glory of God be it spoken, the House at that day, for all the Sickness in it, was a little lower Heaven, so full of Joy and Praise."

15. The Child grew exceedingly in Knowledge, Experience, Patience, Humility and Self-abhorrency; and he thought he could never speak bad enough of himself; the Name that he would call himself by, was a *Toad*.

16. And though he prayed before, yet now the Lord poured out upon him the Spirit of Prayer, in an extraordinary Manner for one of his Age; so that now he prayed more frequently, more earnestly, more spiritually than ever. O how eagerly would he beg to be washed in the Blood of Jesus! And that the King of Kings, and Lord of Lords, that was over Heaven

Heaven and Earth, and Sea, would pardon and forgive him all his Sins, and receive his Soul into his Kingdom. And what he spoke, it was with so much Life and Fervor of Spirit, that it filled the Hearers with Astonishment and Joy.

17. He had no small Sense of the Use and Excellency of Christ, and such Longings and Breathings of his Soul after him; that when mention hath been made of Christ, he hath been ready almost to leap out of his Bed for Joy.

18. When he was told, that if he should recover, he must not live as he list; but he must give up himself to Christ, and to be his Child and Servant, to bear his Yoke and be obedient to his Laws, and live a holy Life, and take his Cross, and suffer Mocking and Reproach, it may be, Persecution for his Name's Sake. Now, Child (said one to him) are you willing to have Christ upon such Terms? He signified his Willingness by the Earnestness of his Looks and Words, and the casting up of his Eyes to Heaven, saying, Yes, with all my Soul, the Lord help me, I will do this.

19. Yet he had many Doubts and Fears, and was ever and anon harping upon that, That tho' he were willing, yet Christ he feared was not willing to accept him, because of the greatness of his Sins; yet his Hopes were greater than his Fears.

20. The Wednesday before he died, the Child lay as it were in a Trance for about half an Hour, in which Time he thought he saw a Vision of Angels: When he was out of his Trance, he was in a little Pet; and asked his Nurse, Why she did not let him go? Go, whichever Child, said she: Why along with those brave Gentlemen (said he) but they told me they would come and fetch me for all you upon Friday next. And he doubled his Words many Times: Upon Friday next those brave Gentlemen will come for me; and upon that Day, the Child died joyfully.

21. He was very thankful to his Master, and very sensible of his great Kindness in taking him out of the Street, when he was a begging: And he admired at the goodness of God, which put it into the Mind of a Stranger to look upon, and to take such a fatherly Care of such a pitiful sorry Creature as he was. O my dear Master (said he) and Servant of God, I hope to see you in Heaven, for I am sure you will go thither.

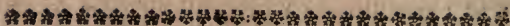
O blessed, blessed be God, that made you to take Pity upon me;

ne, for I might have died, and have gone to the Devil, and have been damned for ever, if it had not been for you.

22. The Thursday before he died, he asked a very godly Friend of mine, What he thought of his Condition, and whither his Soul was now going? For he said, He could not still but fear, lest he should deceive himself with false Hopes. At which my Friend spoke to him thus, Child. For all that I have endeavoured to hold forth the Grace of God in Christ to thy Soul, and given you a Warrant from the Word of God that Christ is as freely offered to you, as to any Sinner in the World; if you are but willing to accept of him, thou mayest have Christ, and all that thou dost want with Him; and yet thou dost give Way to these thy Doubtings and Fears. as tho' I told you nothing but Lies. Thou sayest, thou fearest that Christ will not accept of thee; I fear thou art not heartily willing to accept of Him. The Child answered, Indeed I am: Why then Child, if thou art unfeignedly willing to have Christ, I tell thee, He is a thousand Times more willing to have thee, and wash thee, and save thee, than thou art to desire it. And now at this Time Christ offers himself freely to thee again; therefore receive him humbly by Faith into thy Heart, and bid him welcome, for he deserveth it. Upon which Words the Lord discovered his Love to the Child, and he gave a kind of Leap in his Bed, and snapt his Fingers and Thumb together with Abundance of Joy, as much as to say, Well, yea all is well, the Match is made, Christ is willing, and I am willing too; and now Christ is mine, and I am his for ever. And from that Time forward, in full Joy and Assurance of God's Love, he continued earnestly praising God, with desiring to die, and be with Christ. And on Friday Morning he sweetly went to Rest, using that very Expression, Into thy Hands, Lord, I commit my Spirit. He died punctually at that Time which he had spoke of, and in which he expected those Angels to come to him; he was not much above nine Years old when he died.

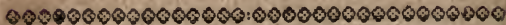
This Narrative I had from a judicious holy Man, unrelated to him, who was an Eye and Ear-Witness to all these Things.

The End of the First Part.



On the Death and Funeral of PIOUS CHILDREN.

BLEST Door of Bliss to weary Saints;
 Thou art grim Death become;
 Secur'd as in a Cabinet,
 Their Dust is in the Tomb.
 By Death they enter to those Joys,
 Prepar'd for them above,
 There they are ever swallow'd up
 In endless Life and Love.
 O! there they see as they are seen,
 With clear unclouded Views;
 O! there they hear of nothing else
 But joyful glorious News.
 Anthems of Joy and Praise are there,
 With Hallelujahs sung:
 Who would be fond of this vain World,
 This Dress, this Dirt, this Dung?
 There Saints for ever do behold,
 Their dearest JESUS' Face:
 There always they admiring are
 Eternal boundless Grace,
 They're in the House not made with Hands,
 In Heav'n eternally
 They dwell, and with the Rays of Christ
 They shine most gloriously.
 Quite freed from Labour, Sorrow, Sin,
 From Cumbrance, Peril, Pain;
 Then we shall find whate'er we did
 For Christ, was not in vain.
 Now Heaven's Work is here begun,
 The Work of singing Praise;
 The Work and Will of GOD in CHRIST,
 Which there we'll work always.



A
T O K E N
F O R
C H I L D R E N.

The SECOND PART.

B E I N G

A farther Account of the Conversion, holy and exemplary Lives and joyful Deaths of several Young Children, not published in the *First Part*.

Pfal. viii. 2. *Out of the Mouth of BABES and SUCKLINGS thou hast ordained Strength.*

Christian Reader,

IN the former Part of my Token for Children, I did in Part promise, that if that Piece met with kind Entertainment, it might be followed with a second of the same Nature. If it did not seem to favour a little of Vanity, I might tell the World what Encouragement I have met with in this Work; but then I will only say, that I have met with so much, as hath perswaded me to give this little Book Leave to go abroad into the World. I am not also ignorant, what Discouragement I may meet with from some; but as long as I am sure I shall not meet with this, that it's improbable, if not impossible, that it should save a Soul; I think the rest may easily be answered, or warrantably slighted. But because I am perswaded by some, that one Example in the former (viz. that of a Child that began to be serious between two and three Years old) was scarce credible, and they did fear might somewhat prejudice the Authority of the rest, I shall say something to answer that. They which make this Objection, are either Good or Bad; if Bad, I expect never to satisfy them, except I should tell them a Romance or Play, or somewhat that might suit a carnal Mind; it is like Holiness in older Persons, it is a Matter of Contempt and Scorn to them, much more in such as these I mention. The Truth of it is, it is no Wonder at all to me that the Subjects of Satan should not be very well pleased with that, whose Design is to undermine the Interest of their great Master: Nothing will satisfy some, except Christ and Holiness may be degraded and vilified.

To the R E A D E R.

But hold Sinner, hold, never hope it, Heaven shall never be turned into Hell for thy sake : and as for thy Atheistical Objections, Scoffs and Jeers, they shall e'er long be fully answered ; and the Hosannah's and Hallelujah's of these sweet Babes shall condemn thy Oaths, Blasphemies and Jeers, and then thou wilt be silenced : and except converting Grace turn thy Heart quickly, thou wilt forever rue thy Madness and Folly, when it is too late to remedy it.

But if the Persons who make this Objection are godly, I question not but that I may give them reasonable Satisfaction.

First. Consider, who it is that I had that Example from. It was one Mrs. *Jeofries* in Long-Lane in Mary Magdalen Bermondsey Parish, in the county of Surry, a Woman of that Fame in the Church of Christ for her exemplary Piety, Wisdom, Experience, and singular Watchfulness over every Punctilio that she speaks, that I question not but that her Name is precious to most of the Ministers of London, at least in the Burrough ; and as a Reverend Divine said, such a Mother in Israel, her single Testimony about London, is of as much Authority almost as any one single Minister's : And having since discoursed this matter with her, she calls God to Witness, that she hath spoken nothing but Truth ; only in this she failed, in that she spake not by far so much as she might have done, concerning that sweet Babe. I might add, that I have since that seen a godly Gentleman out of the Country, that did protest to me, that he had seen as much as that in a little one of the same Age, who since that Time, I hear, went sweetly to Heaven. Doth not the Reverend Mr. Clark, in his Works, quote a Child of two Years old that looked towards Heaven ? Doth not credible History acquaint us with a Martyr at seven Years old, that was whipped almost to Death and never shed one Tear, nor complained ; and at last, had his Head struck off ? I do not speak of these as common Matters, but record them among those stupendous Acts of Him that can as easily work Wonders as not. What is too hard for the Almighty ? Hath God said he will work no more Wonders ? I think most of God's Works in the Business of Conversion call for Admiration : And I believe that Silence, or rather Praise, would better become Saints, than questioning the Truth of such Things : Especially where an apparent Injury is thereby done to the Interest of Christ, the Honour of God's Grace, and the Reputation of so eminent a Saint. I judge this sufficient to satisfy most ; as for others, I trouble not myself, if I may but promote the Interest of Christ, and the good of Souls, and give up my Account with Joy, it's enough. That the Lord would bless my Endeavours to these Ends, I beg the Prayers of all Saints, and yours also sweet Children that fear the Lord. And that Parents and Masters would assist me with their warm Application of these Things ; and that Children may be their Crown and their Joy, is the Prayer of one that desires to love Christ and little Children dearly,

James Janeway.

A Token for CHILDREN.

The SECOND PART.

EXAMPLE VIII.

Of a Child that was very serious at four Years old, with an Account of his comfortable Death, when he was twelve Years and three Weeks old.

JOH^N Sudlow, was born of religious Parents, in the County of *Middlesex*, whose great Care was to instil spiritual Principles into him, as soon as he was capable of understanding of them; whose Endeavours the Lord was pleased to crown with the desired Success; So that (to use the Expression of a holy Man concerning him) Scarce more could be expected or desired from so little a One.

2. When he was scarce able to speak plain, he seemed to have a great Awe and Réverence of God upon his Spirit, and a strange Sense of the Things of another World, as might easily be perceiv'd by those serious and admirable Questions which he would be oft asking of those Christians that he thought he might be bold with.

3. The first Thing that did most affect him, and made him endeavour to escape from the wrath to come, and enquire what he should do to be saved, was the Death of a little Brother; when he saw him without Breath, and not able to speak or stir, and then carried out of Doors, and put into a Pit-hole, he was greatly concerned, and asked notable Questions about him; but that which was most affecting of himself and others was, Whether he must Die too? which being answered, it
made

made such a deep Impression upon him, that from that Time forward he was exceeding serious, and this was when he was about four Years old.

4. Now he is desirous to know what he might do that he might live in another World, and what he must avoid, that he might not die forever, and being instructed by his godly Parents, he soon labours to avoid whatsoever might displease God; now tell him that any thing was sinful, and that God would not have him to do it, and he is easily kept from it; and even at this Time of Day, the Apprehensions of God and Death and Eternity laid such a Restraint upon him, that he would not for a World have told a Lie.

5. He quickly learnt to read exactly, and took such pleasure in reading the Scriptures, and his Catechism, and other good Books, that it is scarce to be parallel'd; he would naturally run to his Book without bidding, when he came Home from School, and when other children of his Age and Acquaintance were playing, he reckon'd it his Recreation to be doing that which is good.

6. When he was in Coats he would still be asking his Maid serious Questions, and praying her to teach him his Catechism, or Scriptures, or some good things; common Discourse he took no Delight in, but did most eagerly desire to be sacking in the Knowledge of the Things of God, Christ, his Soul and another World.

7. He was hugely taken with the reading of the Book of Martyrs, and would be ready to leave his Dinner to go to his Book.

8. He was exceeding careful in redeeming and improving of Time; scarce a Moment of it, but he would give an excellent Account of the Expence of it; so that this Child might have taught elder Persons, and questionless condemn their idle and unaccountable wastings of those precious Hours in which they should (as this sweet Child) have been laying in Provision for Eternity.

9. He could not endure to read any thing over slightly, but whatsoever he read, he dwelt upon it, and laboured to understand it thoroughly and remember it, and what he could not understand he would oft ask his Father or Mother the Meaning of it.

10. When

10. When any Christian Friends have been discoursing with his Father, if they began to talk any Thing about Religion, to be sure they should have his Company, and of his own Accord, he would leave all to hear any Thing of Christ, and crept as close to them as he could, and listen as affectionately, though it were for an Hour or two : He was scarce ever known to express the least Token of Weariness while he was hearing any Thing that was Good, and sometimes when Neighbours Children would come and call him out and entice him, and beg of him to go with them, he could by no Means be perswaded (though he might have had the Leave of his Parents) if he had any hopes that any Body would come into his Father's House.

11. He was very modest whilst any Stranger was present, and was loth to ask them any Questions : but as soon as they were gone, he would let his Father know that there was little said or done, but he observed it, and would reflect upon what was past in their Discourse, and desire Satisfaction in what he could not understand at present.

12. He was a Boy of most prodigious Parts for his Age, as will appear from his solid and rational Questions ; I shall mention but two of many.

13. The first was this, when he was reading by himself, in *Draughton's* Poems about *Noah's* Flood and the Ark, he asked, Who built the Ark ? It being answered, that it was likely that *Noah* hired Men to help him build it : And would they (said he) build an Ark to save another, and not go into it themselves ?

14. Another Question he put was this : Whether had greater Glory, Saints or Angels ? It being answered, that Angels were the most excellent of Creatures and it's to be thought their Nature is made capable of greater Glory than Man's. He said, he was of another Mind, and his Reason was, because Angels were Servants, and Saints are Children ; and that Christ never took upon him the Nature of Angels, but he took upon him the Nature of Saints, and by his being MAN, he hath advanced Human Nature above the Nature of Angels.

15. By this you may perceive the greatness of his Parts, and the bent of his Thoughts ; and thus he continued for several Years together, labouring to get more and more spiritual Knowledge, and to prepare for an endless Life.

16. He

16. He was a Child of an excellent sweet Temper, wonderfully dutiful to his Parents, ready and joyful to do what he was bid, and by no Means would do any Thing to displease them, and if they were at any Time seemingly angry, he would not stir from them, till they were thoroughly reconciled to him.

17. He was not only good himself, but would do what he could to make others so too, especially those that were nearest to him; he was very watchful over his Brethren and Sisters, and would not suffer them to use any unhandsome Words, or to do any unhandsome Action, but he would be putting them upon that which was Good; and when he did at any Time rebuke them, it was not childishly and slightly, but with great Gravity, and Seriousness, as one that was not a little concerned for God's Honour; and the eternal Welfare of their Souls.

18. He would go to his Father and Mother with great Tenderness and Compassion (being far from telling of Tales) and beg of them, to take more Care of the Souls of his Brethren and Sisters, and to take heed, lest they should go on in a sinful Christless State, and prove their Sorrow and Shame, and go to Hell when they die, and be ruined forever.

19. He was exceedingly affected with hearing the Word of God preached, and could not be satisfied except he could carry home much of the Substance of what he had heard; to this end he quickly got to learn short Hand, and would give a very pretty Account of any Sermon that he heard.

20. He was much engaged in secret Duty, and in reading the Scriptures: to be sure Morning and Evening he would be by himself, and was, no Question, wrestling with God.

21. He would get choice Scriptures by Heart, and was very perfect at his Catechism.

22. The Providences of God were not passed by without considerable Observation by him.

23. In the Time of the Plague, he was exceedingly concerned about his Soul and everlasting State.

This prayer was found written in Short-Hand after his Death.

O LORD GOD and merciful Father, take pity upon me a miserable Sinner, and strengthen me, O Lord, in thy Faith, and make me one of thy glorious Saints in Heaven. O Lord, keep me from this poisonous Infection; however, not my Will but thy Will be done, O Lord, on Earth, as it is in Heaven; but, O Lord, if thou hast appointed me to die by it, O Lord, fit me for Death, and give me a good Heart to bear up under my Afflictions: O Lord God and merciful Father, take pity upon me thy Child; teach me, O Lord, thy Word, make me strong in Faith. O Lord, I have sinned against thee; Lord pardon my Sins. I had been in Hell long ago, if it had not been for thy Mercy: O Lord, I pray thee to keep my Parents in thy Truth, and save them from this Infection, if it be thy Will, that they may live to bring me up in thy Truth: O Lord, I pray thee slay this Infection that rageth in this City, and pardon their Sins, and try them once more, and see if they will turn unto thee. Save me, O Lord, from this Infection, that I may live to praise and glorify thy Name; but, O Lord, if thou hast appointed me to die of it, fit me for Death, that I may die with Comfort; and, O Lord, I pray thee to help me to bear up under all Afflictions, for Christ's Sake. Amen.

24. He was not a little concerned for the whole Nation; and begged that God would pardon the Sins of this Land, and bring it nearer to himself.

25. About the Beginning of November 1665, this sweet Child was smote with the Distemper, but he carried it with admirable Patience under the Hand of God.

26. These were some of his dying Expressions—The Lord shall be my Physician, for he will cure both Soul and Body—Heaven is the best Happiness—It is the Lord, let him do what seemeth good in his Eyes.—Again,—It is the Lord that taketh away my Health; but I will say as Job said, *Blessed be the Name of the Lord.*—If I should live longer, I shall but sin against God. Looking upon his Father, he said, If the Lord would but lend me the least Finger of his Hand to lead me through the dark Entry of Death, I will rejoice in him.

27. When a Minister came to him, among other Things, he spake somewhat of Life. He said, This is a wicked World, yet it is good to live with my Parents, but it is better to live in Heaven.

28. An Hour and an half before his Death, the same Minister came again to visit him, and asked him, John, art thou afraid to die? He answered, No, if the Lord will but comfort me in that Hour. But, said the Minister, How canst thou expect Comfort, seeing we deserve none? He answered, No, if I had my Deserts, I had been in Hell long ago. But, replied the Minister, Which Way dost thou expect Comfort and Salvation, seeing thou art a Sinner? He answered, In Christ alone. — In about an Hour and an Half after he fell asleep, saying. He would take a long Sleep, charging them that were about him not to wake him.

He died when he was twelve Years, three Weeks and one Day old.

EXAMPLE IX.

Of a Child that was very eminent, when she was between five and six Years old, with some memorable Passages of her Life, who died about 1640.

1. **A**Nne Lane was born of honest Parents in Colebrook, in the County of Bucks, who was no sooner able to speak plain, and express any thing considerable of Reason, but she began to act as if she were sanctified from the very Womb.

2. She was very solicitous about her Soul, what would become of it when she should die, and where she should live for ever, and what she should do to be saved, when she was about Five Years old.

3. She was wont to be oft engaged in secret Prayer, and pouring out her Soul in such a Manner, as is rarely to be heard of from one of her Years.

4. I having Occasion to lie at Colebrook, sent for her Father, an old Disciple, an Israelite indeed, and desired him to give me some Account of his Experiences, and how the Lord first wrought upon him?

5 He gave me this answer, " That he was of a Child somewhat civil; honest, and as to a Man, harmless; but he was little acquainted with the power of Religion, till this sweet Child put him upon a thorough inquiry into the state of his Soul, and would still be begging of him, and pleading with him to redeem his time, and to act with life and vigour

vigour in the things of God, which was no small demonstration to him of the reality of Invisibles, that a very Babe and Suckling should speak so feelingly about the Things of God, and be so greatly concerned, not only about her own Soul, but about her Father's too, which was the occasion of his Conversion, and the very thought of it was a quickening to him for thirty Years, and he hopes never to wear off the Impression of it from his Spirit."

6 After this she put her Father upon Family Duties, and if he was for any time out of his Shop, she would find him out, and with much sweetness and humility beg of him to come home, and remember the preciousness of Time, for which we must all give an account.

7. She was grieved if she saw any that conversed with her Father, if they were unprofitable, unsavory, or long in their discourse of common Things.

8 Her own Language was the Language of Canaan: How solidly, profitably, and spiritually would she talk! So that she made good people take great delight in her Company, and justly drew the Admiration of all that knew her.

9. She could not endure the Company of common Children, nor Play, but was quite above all those Things which most Children are taken with; her Business was to be reading, praying, discoursing about the Things of God, and any kind of Business that her Age and Strength was capable of: Idle she would not be by any Means.

10. It was the greatest Recreation to her to hear any good People talking about God, Christ, their Souls, the Scriptures, or any Thing that concerned another Life.

11. She had a strange contempt of the World, and scorned those Things which most are too much pleased with. She could not be brought to wear any Laces, or any thing that she thought was superfluous.

12. She would be complaining to her Parents if she saw any thing in them that she judged would not be for the Honour of Religion, or suitable to that Condition which the Providence of God had set them in, in the World.

13. This Child was the Joy and Delight of all the Christians thereabouts, in those Times, who was still quickning

and raising of the Spirits of those that talked with her. This poor Babe was a great help to both Father and Mother, and her Memory is sweet to this Day.

14. She continued thus to walk as a Stranger in the World, and one that was making haste to a better Place. And after she had done a great Deal of Work called Home to rest, and received into the Arms of JESUS, before she was ten Years old; she departed about 1640.

EXAMPLE X.

Of a Child that was awakened when she was between 7 and 8 Years old, with some Account of her last Hours, and triumphant Death.

1. **T**Abitha Alder was a Daughter of a holy and reverend Minister in Kent, who lived near Gravesend. She was much instructed in the holy Scriptures and her Catechism, by her Father and Mother, but there appeared nothing extraordinary in her, till she was between Seven and Eight Years old.

2. About which Time, when she was sick, one asked her, What she thought would become of her if she should die? she answered, That she was greatly afraid she should go to Hell.

3. Being asked, why she was afraid of going to Hell? She answered, Because she feared she did not love God.

4. Again being asked, How she did know that she did not love God? She replied, what have I done for God ever since I was born? And besides this I have been taught, That he that loves God keeps his Commandments, but I have kept none of them all.

5. Being further demanded, If she would not fain love God? She answered, Yes, with all her Heart, if she could, but she found it a hard Thing to love one she did not see.

6. She was advised to beg of God a Heart to love him; she answered, She was afraid it was too late.

7. Being asked again, whether she was not sorry that she could not love God? She answered, Yes, but still was afraid it was too late.

8. Upon

8. Upon this, seeing her in such a desponding Condition, a dear Friend of hers spent the next Day in Fasting and Prayer for her.

9. After this that Christian Friend asked her how she did now? She answered with a great deal of Joy, That now, she blessed the Lord, she loved the Lord Jesus dearly, she felt she did love him; Oh! said she, I love him dearly.

10. Why, said her Friend, did you not say Yesterday, that you did not love the Lord, and that you could not? What did you mean to speak so strangely? Sure (said she) it was Satan that did put it into my Mind: But now I love him, O blessed be God for the Lord Jesus Christ.

11. After this she had a Discovery of her approaching Dissolution, which was no small Comfort to her: Anon, (said she, with a holy Triumph) I shall be with Jesus, I am married to him, He is my Husband, I am his Bride, I have given myself to him, and he hath given himself to me, and I shall live with him for ever.

12. This strange Language made the Hearers even stand astonished: But thus she continued for some little Time, in a Kind of Extasy of Joy, admiring the Excellency of Christ, rejoicing in her Interest in him, and longing to be with him.

13. After a while, some of her Friends standing by her, observed a more than ordinary Earnestness and Fixedness in her Countenance; they said one to another, Look how earnestly she looks, sure she seeth something.

14. One asked, What it was she fixed her Eyes upon so eagerly; I warrant (saith one that was by) she seeth Death a coming.

15. No (saith she) it is Glory that I see, it is that I fix my Eye upon.

16. One asked her, What was Glory like? She answered, I can't speak what, but I am going to it; will you go with me to that Glory! With which Words her Soul took Wing, and went to the Possession of that Glory which she had some believing Sight of before.

She died when she was between eight and nine Years old, about 1644.

EXAMPLE XI.

Of a Child that was greatly affected with the Things of God, when she was very young, with an exact Account of her admirable Carriage upon her Death-Bed.

1. *S*Ufannah Bicks was born at *Leiden* in *Holland*, Jan. 24. 1650, of very religious Parents, whose great Care was to instruct and catechise this their Child, and to present her to the Ministers of the Place, to be publicly instructed and catechised.

2. It pleased the Lord to bless the holy Education and good Example of her Parents, and Catechising, to the good of her Soul, so that she soon had a true Savour and Relish of what she was taught, and made an admirable Use of it in a Time of Need, as you shall hear afterwards.

3. She was a Child of great Dutifulness to her Parents, and of a sweet, humble, spiritual Nature, and not only the Truth, but the Power and Eminency of Religion did shine in her so clearly, that she did not only comfort the Hearts of her Parents, but drew the Admiration of all that were Witnesses of God's Work of Love on her, and may well be proposed as a Pattern not only to Children, but to Persons of riper Years.

4. She continued in a Course of religious Duties for some considerable Time, so that her Life was more excellent than most Christians, but in her last Sickness she excelled her self, and her Deportment was so admirable, that partly through Wonder and Astonishment, and partly through Sorrow, many observable Things were passed by without committing to Paper, which deserved to have been written in Letters of Gold: But take these which follow, as some of the many that were taken from her dying Lips, and first published by religious and judicious Christians in *Dutch*, afterwards translated into *Scotch*, and with a little Alteration of the Stile (for the Benefit of *English* Children) brought into this Form by me.

5. In the Month of August 1664, when the Pestilence raged so much in *Holland*, this sweet Child was smitten, and as soon as she felt herself very ill, she was said to break forth with abundance of Sense and Feeling, in these Words: If thy Law were not my Delight, I should perish in my Affliction.

6. Her

6. Her Father coming to her to encourage her in her Sickness, said to her, Be of good comfort, my Child, for the Lord will be near to thee and us, under this heavy Trial : He will not forsake us, though he chasten us. Yea, Father (said she) our heavenly Father doth chasten us for our Profit, that we may be Partakers of his Holiness : No Chastisement seemeth for the present to be joyous but grievous, yet afterwards it yieldeth the peaceable Fruits of Righteousness to them which are exercised thereby. The Lord is now chastening of me upon this sick Bed, But I hope he will bless it so to me, as to cause it to yield to me that blessed Fruit, according to the Riches of his Mercies, which fail not.

7. After this, she spake to God with her Eyes lift up to Heaven, saying, Be merciful to me, O Father, be merciful to me a Sinner, according to thy Word.

8. Then, looking upon her sorrowful Parents, she said, It is said, Cast thy Burden upon the Lord, and He shall sustain thee, and he will never suffer the righteous to be moved. Therefore, my dear Father and Mother, cast all your Care upon him, who causes all Things to go well that concern you.

9. Her Mother said unto her, O my dear Child, I have no small comfort from the Lord in thee, and the Fruit of his Grace, whereby thou hast been so much exercised unto Godliness in reading the Word, in Prayer and gracious Discourse to the Edification of thyself and us. The Lord himself who gave thee to us, make up this Loss, if it be his Pleasure to take thee away from us.

10. Dear Mother (said she) tho' I leave you, and you me, yet God will never leave us ; for it is said, Can a Woman forget her sucking Child, that she should not have Compassion on the Fruit of her Womb, yet will not I forget thee : Behold I have graven thee upon the Palms of my Hands. O comfortable Words, both for Mother and Children ! Mark, dear Mother, how fast the Lord keeps and holdeth his People, that he doth even grave them upon the Palms of his Hands. Tho' I must part with you, and you with me, yet blessed be God, he will never part either from you or me.

11. Being weary with much speaking, she desired to rest a while ; but after a little time awaking again, her Father asked, how it was with her ? She made no direct answer, but

but asked what Day it was? Her Father said, it was the Lord's Day. Well then, said she, Have you given up my Name to be remembered in the public Prayers of the Church? Her Father told her he had. I have learnt, said she. That the effectual fervent Prayer of the Righteous availeth much.

12. She had a very high Esteem for the faithful Ministers of Christ, and much desired their Company where she was, but knowing the Hazard that such a Visit might expose them and the Church to, she would by no means suffer that the Ministers should come near her Person, but chose rather to throw herself upon the Arms of the Lord, and to improve that Knowledge she had in the Word, her former Experience, and the Visits of private Christians, and those whom the Church had appointed in such Cases, to visit and comfort the Sick.

13. One of those which came to visit her, was of very great Use to comfort her, and lift her up in some Measure above the Fears of Death.

14. Though young, she was very much concerned for the Interest of God and Religion, for Gospel-Ministers, and for the Sins and Decay of the Power of Godliness in her own Country; which will further appear by what may follow.

15. Her Father coming in to her, found her in an extraordinary Passion of weeping, and asked her what was the Cause of her great Sorrow: She answered, Have I not cause to weep, when I hear that *Domine De Wit* was taken sick this Day in his Pulpit, and went home very ill? Is not this a sad Sign of God's Displeasure to our Country, when he smiteth such a faithful Pastor.

16. She had a high Valuation of God, and could speak in David's Language, *Whom have I in Heaven but Thee, and there is none on Earth that I can desire in comparison of Thee.* She was much lifted above the Fears of Death; what else was the Meaning of such Expressions as these? O how do I long! even as the Hart panteth after thee, O God, for God, the living God, when shall I come and appear before God.

17. She was a great Hater of Sin, and did with much Grief and Self-Abhorrency reflect upon it; but that which lay most upon her Heart, was the Corruption of her Nature and original Sin. How oft would she cry out in the Words of the Psalmist, Behold, I was shapen in Iniquity, and in Sin

did my Mother conceive me : And I was altogether born in Sin. She could never lay herself low enough under a Sense of that original Sin which she brought with her into the World.

18. She spake many Things very judiciously of the old Man, and putting it off, and of the new Man, and putting that on; which shewed that she was no Stranger to Conversion, and that she in some Measure understood what Mortification, Self-denial, and taking up of her Cross, and following Christ meant. That Scripture was much in her Mouth, The Sacrifices of God are a contrite Heart; a broken and a contrite Spirit, O God, thou wilt not despise. That Brokenness of Heart (said she) which is built upon and flows from Faith, and that Faith which is built upon Christ, who is the proper and alone Sacrifice for Sin. These are her own Words.

19. Afterwards she desired to rest, and when she had slumbered a while, she said, O dear Father and Mother, how weak I do feel myself ! My dear Child (said her Father) God will in his tender Mercy strengthen thee in thy Weakness. Yea Father (said she) that is my Confidence; For it is said. The bruised Reed he will not break, and the smoking Flax he will not quench.

20. Then she discoursed excellently of the Nature of Faith, and desired that the Eleventh of Hebrews should be read unto her; at the reading of which she cried out, O what a stedfast loyal Faith was that of *Abraham*, which made him willing to offer up his own and only Son ! Faith is the Substance of Things hoped for, and the Evidence of Things not seen.

21. Her Father and Mother, hearing her excellent Discourse and seeing her excellent Carriage, burst out in Abundance of Tears. Upon which she pleaded with them to be patient, and content with the Hand of God. O (said she) why do you weep at this Rate over me, seeing, I hope, you have no Reason to question, but if the Lord take me out of this miserable World, it shall be well with me to all Eternity. You ought to be well satisfied seeing it is said, *God is in Heaven, and doth whatsoever pleaseth Him* : And do not you pray every Day, That the Will of God may be done upon Earth, as it is in Heaven? Now Father, this is God's Will, that I should lie upon this sick Bed, and of this Disease; shall we not be content when our Prayers are answered? Would not your extream

Sorrow be murmuring against God, without whose good Pleasure nothing comes to pass. Altho' I am struck with this Disease, yet because it is the Will of God, that doth silence me; and I will, as long as I live, pray that God's Will may be done, and not mine.

22. Seeing her Parents still very much moved, she further argued with them from the Providence of God, which had a special Hand in every common Thing, much more in the Disposal of the Lives of Men and Women: And are not two Sparrows sold for a Farthing, and not one of them falls to the Ground without our heavenly Father? Yea, the very Hairs of our Head are all numbered: therefore fear not, you are of more Value than many Sparrows. Adversity and Prosperity they are both good. Some Things appear Evil in our Eyes, but the Lord turns all to the Good of them who are his.

23. She came to speak particularly concerning the Plague. Doth not (said she) the Pestilence come from God? Why else doth the Scripture say. Shall there be Evil in the City which I have not sent? What do these People mean, which say, the Pestilence comes from the Air? Is not the Lord the Creator and Ruler of the Air, and are not the Elements under his Government? Or if they say, it comes from the Earth, hath he not the same Power and Influence upon that too? Why talk they of a Ship that came from *Africa*? Have we not read long ago, Lev. xxvi. 25. I shall bring a Sword upon you, and avenge the Quarrel of my Covenant; and when you are assembled in the Cities, then will I bring the Pestilence in the midst of you.

24. After this. having taken some little Rest, she said, O now is the Day for opening of the first Question of the Catechism, and if we were there, we should hear, that whether in Death or Life, a Believer is Christ's, who hath redeemed us by his own precious Blood from the Power of the Devil: And then she quoted Rom. xiv. 7, 8. For none of us liveth unto himself, and none of us dieth unto himself. For whether we live we live unto the Lord, and whether we die we die unto the Lord; whether then we live or die, we are the Lord's. — Then be comforted, for whether I live or die, I am the Lord's. O why do you afflict yourselves thus! But what shall I say? With weeping I came into the World, and with weeping I must go out again. O my dear Parents. Better is the Day of my Death than the Day of my Birth.

25. When

25. When she had thus encouraged her Father and Mother she desired her Father to pray with her, and to request of the Lord that she might have a quiet and peaceable Passage into another World.

26. After her Father had prayed for her, he asked her, whether he should send for the Physician; she answered, By no means, for I am now beyond the Help of Doctors. But, said he, my Child, we are to use the ordinary Means appointed by the Lord for our Help, as long as we live, and let the Lord do as seemeth good in his Eyes. But, said she, Give me the heavenly Physician: He is the only Helper. Doth not he say, Come unto me all ye that are weary and heavy laden, and I will give you Rest: And doth not he bid us call upon him in the Day of Distress, and he will deliver us, and we shall glorify him: Therefore, dear Father, call upon him yet again for me.

27. About this time a Christian Friend came in to visit her, who was not a little comforted when he heard and saw so much of the Grace of God living in a poor young Thing, which could not but so far affect him as to draw Tears of Joy and Admiration from him, and her Deportment was so reaching that he could not but acknowledge himself greatly edified and improved by her Carriage and Language.

28. That which was not the least observable in her, was the ardent Affection she had for the holy Scriptures and her Catechism, in which she was thoroughly instructed by the Divines of the Place where she lived, which she could not but own as one of the greatest Mercies next to the Lord Christ. O how she did bless God for her Catechism, and beg of her Father to go particularly to those Ministers that had taken so much Pains with her to instruct her in her Catechism, and to thank them from her a dying Child for their good Instructions, and to let them understand, for their Encouragement to go on in the Work of Catechising, how refreshing those Truths were now to her in the Hour of her Distress. O that sweet Catechising, said she, unto which I did always resort with Gladness, and attended without Weariness.

29. She was much above the Vanities of the World, and took no Pleasure at all in those Things which usually take up the Heart and Time of young Ones. She would say, that

she was grieved and ashamed both for Young and Old, to see how glad and mad they were upon Vanity, and how foolishly they spent their Time.

30. She was not forgetful of the Care and Love of her Master and Mistress who taught her to Read and Work, but she desired that Thanks might be particularly given to them. Indeed she thought she could never be thankful enough both to God and man for that Kindness that she had Experience of : But again and again, she desired to be sure to thank the Ministers who instructed her, either by Catechising or Preaching.

31. After some Rest, her Father asked her again, How she did, and began to express somewhat of that Satisfaction and Joy that he had taken in her former Diligence, in her reading the Scriptures, and Writing, and her Dutifulness, and that Progress she had made in the the Things of God : Upon which she humbly and sweetly desired to own God and his Kindness in her godly Education, and said she esteemed her holy Education under such Parents and Ministers as a greater Portion than ten Thousand Guilders, for thereby I have learned to comfort my self out of the Word of God, which the World besides could never have afforded.

32. Her Father perceiving her to grow very weak said, I perceive Child, thou art very weak ; It is true Sir (said she) I feel my Weakness increaseth and I see your Sorrow increasing too ; which is a Piece of my Affliction : Be content, I pray you. It is the Lord which doth it and let you and I say with *David*, Let us fall into the Lord's Hands, for his Mercies are great.

33. She laid a great charge upon her Parents not to be over-grieved for her after her Death, urging that of *David* on them ; while the Child was sick, he fasted and wept, but when it died, he washed his Face and sat up and eat, and said, Can I bring him back again from Death ? I shall go to him, but he shall not return me. So ought you to say after my Death, Our Child is well ; for we know it shall be well with them that trust in the Lord. She did lay a more particular and strait Charge upon her Mother ; saying to her, Dear Mother, who have done so much for me, you must promise me one Thing more before I die ; and that is, That you will not sorrow overmuch for me : I speak thus to you, because

because am afraid of your great Affliction. Consider other Losses, what they have been, remember *Job*, forget not what Christ foretold, In the World you shall have Tribulation, but be of good Cheer, in me you shall have Peace. And must the Apostles suffer so great Tribulation, and must we suffer none? Did not Jesus Christ my only Life and Saviour, sweat Drops of Blood? Was he not in bitter Agony, mocked, spit at, nailed to the Cross, and a Spear thrust through his blessed Side, and all this for my sake, for my stinking Sins sake? Did he not cry out, My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me? Did not Christ hang naked upon the Cross to purchase for me the Garments of Salvation, and to cloath me with his Righteousness, for there is Salvation in no other Name.

34. Being very feeble and weak, she said, O if I might quietly sleep in the Bosom of Jesus: and that till then he would strengthen me! O that he would take me into his Arms as he did those little ones, where he said, Suffer little children to come unto me, for of such is the Kingdom of Heaven, and he took them into his Arms, and laid his Hands on them and blessed them. I lie here as a Child, O Lord, I am thy Child, receive me into thy gracious Arms. O Lord, Grace! Grace! and not Justice! for if thou shouldst enter into judgment with me, I cannot stand, yea, none living should be just in thy Sight.

35. After this she cried out, O how faint am I! But fearing lest she should dishearten her Mother, she said, While there is Life, there is Hope: If it should please the Lord to recover me, how careful would I be to please you in my Work and Learning, and whatsoever you should require of me!

36. After this, the Lord did again send her Strength, and she laboured to spend it all for Christ, in the awakening, edifying and comforting of those who were about her; but her chiefest Endeavour was to support her dear Parents from extraordinary Sorrow, and to comfort them out of the Scriptures, telling them, That she knew that all Things did work together for the good of them that did love God, even to those who are called according to his Purpose. O God, establish me with thy free Spirit! Who shall separate us from the Love of Christ? I am persuaded, that neither Life, nor

Death,

Death, nor Angels, nor Principalities, nor Powers, nor Things present, nor Things to come, nor Height, nor any other Creature, shall separate us from the Love of God, which is towards us in Christ Jesus our Lord. My Sheep (saith Christ) hear my Voice, and I know them, and they follow me, and I give unto them eternal Life, and they shall never perish, and no Man shall pluck them out of my Hands. My Father who gave them me is greater than all, and none shall pluck them out of my Father's Hands. Thus she seemed to attain to a holy Confidence in God, and an Assurance of her State as to another World.

37. When she had a little refreshed herself with Rest, she burst forth with Abundance of Joy and Gladness of Heart, with a holy Triumph of Faith, saying out, Death is swallowed up in Victory: O Death, where is thy Sting! O Grave, where is thy Victory! The Sting of Death is Sin, and the Strength of Sin is the Law; but Thanks be to God, who hath given us the Victory through our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.

38. That she might the better support her Friends, she still insisted upon that which might take off some of their Burden, by urging the Necessity of Death: We are from the Earth, and to the Earth we must return; Dust is the Mother of us all, the Dust shall return to the Dust, from whence it is; and the Spirit to God who gave it.

39. Then she discoursed of the Shortness of Man's Life. O what is the Life of Man! The Days of Man upon the Earth are as the Grass, and the Flowers of the Field, so he flourisheth, the Wind passeth over it, and it is no more, and his Place knows him no more.

40. She further urged the Sin and Sorrow that did attend us in this Life, and the longer we live, the more we sin; now the Lord will free me from that Sin and Sorrow. We know not the Thoughts of God, yet do we know so much, that they are Mercy and Peace, and do give an expected End. But what shall I say, my Life shall not continue long, I feel much Weakness. O Lord, look upon me graciously, have pity upon my weak distressed Heart. I am oppressed, undertake for me, that I may stand fast and overcome.

41. She was very frequent in spiritual Ejaculations, and it was no small Comfort to her, that the Lord Christ did pray for her, and promise to send his Spirit to comfort her. It is

said

said (said she) I will pray the Father, and he shall give you another Comforter. O let not him leave me ! O Lord, continue with me till my Battle and Work is finished.

42. She had very low and undervaluing Thoughts of herself and her own Righteousness : What meant she else to cry out in such Language as that, *None but Christ !* Without Thee I can do nothing ! Christ is the Vine ! O let me be a Branch of that Vine ! What poor Worms are we ! O dear Father, how lame and halting do we go in the Ways of God and Salvation ? We know but in part, but when that which is perfect is come, then that which is imperfect shall be done away. O that I had attained to that now : But what are we ourselves, not only Weakness and Nothingness, but Wickedness : For all the Thoughts and Imaginations of Man's Heart are only Evil, and that continually : We are by Nature Children of Wrath, and are conceived and born in Sin and Unrighteousness. Oh ! Oh ! this wretched and vile Thing SIN ! But thanks to God, who hath redeemed me from it.

43. She comforted herself and her Father, in that great Scripture, Rom. viii. 15, 16, 17. Ye have not received the Spirit of Bondage again to Fear, but ye have received the Spirit of Adoption, by which we cry, *Abba Father*. It is the Spirit that witnesseth with our Spirits, that we are the Children of God ; and if Children, then we are Heirs, Heirs of God, and Joint-Heirs with Christ. You see thence, Father, that I shall be a Fellow-Heir with Christ, who hath said, In my Father's House are many Mansions, if it were not so, I would have told you. I go to prepare a Place for you, I will come again, and take you to myself, that where I am, there ye may be also. O Lord, take me to thyself. Behold, dear Mother, he hath prepared a Place and Dwelling for me.

44. Yea, my dear Child, said her Mother, He shall strengthen you with his holy Spirit, until he hath fitted and prepared you fully for that Place, which he hath prepared for you.

45. Yea, Mother, it is said in the 84th Psalm, How lovely are thy Tabernacles, O Lord of Hosts, my Soul doth thirst, and longeth for the Courts of the Lord ; One Day in thy Courts is better than a Thousand ; yea, I had rather be a Door-keeper in the House of God, than dwell in the Tents of the Wicked.—Read this Psalm, dear Mother, where-

with

with we may comfort one another. As for me, I am more and more spent, and draw near my last Hour.

46. Then she desired to be prayed with, and begged that the Lord would give her an easy Passage.

47. After this, she turned to her Mother, and with much Affection, she said, Ah, my dear and loving Mother! that which cometh from the Heart doth ordinarily go to the Heart; once more come and kiss me before I leave you.

48. She was not a little concerned about the Souls of her Relations, and did particularly charge it upon her Father, to do what he possibly could to bring them up in the Ways of God. O let my Sister be trained up in the Scriptures, and Catechising, as I have been.

49. I formerly wept for my Sister, thinking that she would die before me, and now she weepeth for me, and then she kissed her weeping Sister. Also she took her young Sister in her Arms, a Child of six Months old, and she kissed it with much Affection, as if her very Bowels had moved within her, and spoke with many Heart-breaking Words, both to her Parents and the Children.

50. Her Father spake to one that was by to take the poor little Child away from her, from the Hazard of that fiery Distemper, and bid his Daughter to give her from her, for he had already too much to bear. Well, Father, said she, did not God preserve the three Children in the fiery Furnace: And did you not teach me that Scripture, *When thou passest thro' the Fire thou shalt not be burnt, neither shall the Flames kindle upon thee.*

51. She had a very strong Faith in the Doctrine of the Resurrection, and did greatly solace her Soul with excellent Scriptures, which do speak the happy State of Believers, as soon as their Souls are separated from their Bodies; and what she quoted out of the Scriptures, she did excellently and suitably apply to her own Use, incomparably above the common Reach of her Sex and Age. That in 1 Cor. xv. 42. was a good Support to her. The Body is sown in Corruption, but it shall be raised in Incorruption: It is sown in Dishonour, it shall be raised in Glory: It is sown in Weakness, but it shall be raised in Power. And then she sweetly applies, and takes in this Cordial, Behold thus it is, and thus it shall be with

my poor mortal Flesh : Blessed are the Dead that die in the Lord, because they rest from their Labour, and their Works do follow them. The Righteous perish and no Man layeth it to Heart, and the Upright are taken away, and no Man regardeth it that they are taken away from the Evil to come. They shall enter into Peace, and they shall rest in their Beds, every one, who walketh in his Uprightness. Behold now, Father, I shall rest and sleep in that Bed-Chamber.

52. Then she quoted Job xix. 25, 26, 27. I know that my Redeemer liveth, and that He shall stand at the latter End upon the Earth; and though after my Skin Worms destroy this Body, yet in my Flesh shall I see God; whom I shall see for my self, and my Eyes shall behold, and not another, tho' my Reins be consumed within me. Behold now Father, this very Skin which you see, and the very Flesh which you see, shall be raised up again; and these very Eyes which now are so dim, shall on that Day see and behold my dear and precious Redeemer; albeit the Worms eat up my Flesh, yet with these Eyes shall I behold God, even I myself, and not another for me.

53. Then she quoted Job v. 28. Marvel not at this, for the Hour is coming in which all that are in their Graves shall come forth; those that have done Good to the Resurrection of Life. See Father, I shall rise in that Day, and then I shall behold my Redeemer; then shall he say, Come ye blessed of my Father, inherit the Kingdom prepared for you before the Beginning of the World.

54. Behold now I live, yet not I, but Christ liveth in me, and the Life that I now live in the Flesh, is by the Faith of the Son of God, who loveth me, and gave himself for me. I am saved, and that not of my self, it is the Gift of God, not of Works, that no Man should boast.

55. My dear Parents, now we must shortly part, my Speech faileth me, pray the Lord for a quiet Close to my Combat.

56. Her Parents replied, Ah our dear Child, how sad is that to us, that we must part? She answered, I go to Heaven, and there we shall find one another again; I go to Jesus Christ.

57. Then she comforted herself to think of seeing her precious Brother and Sister again in Glory. I go to my Brother *Jacob*, who did so much cry and call upon God to the last Moment of his Breath; And to my little Sister who was but three Years old when she died; Who when we asked her, Whether she would die? Answered Yes, if it be the Lord's Will. I will go to my little Brother, if it be the Lord's Will, or I will stay with my Mother, if it be the Lord's Will. But I know that I shall die and go to Heaven and to God. O see, how small a Babe had so much given it to behave itself every way, and in all Things so submissively to the Will of God, as if it had no Will of its own; but if it please God; nothing from her, but what was the Will and Pleasure of God! And therefore dear Father and Mother, give the Lord Thanks for his free and rich Grace, and then I shall the more gladly be gone. Be gracious then, O Lord, unto me also, be gracious to me. Wash me thoroughly from my Unrighteousness, and cleanse me from my Sin.

58. After this her Spirit was refreshed with the Sense of the Pardon of her Sin, which made her to cry out, Behold God hath washed away my Sins, O how do I long to die! The Apostle said, In this Body we earnestly sigh and groan, longing for our House which is in Heaven, that we may be cloathed therewith. Now I also lie here sighing and longing for that Dwelling which is above. In the last Sermon which I heard, or ever shall hear, I heard this in the New-Church, which is Matter of great Comfort to me.

59. Then she repeated several notable Scriptures which were quoted in that Sermon, afterwards she desired to be prayed with, and put Petitions into their Mouths, *viz.* That all her Sins might be forgiven, That she might have more abundant Faith, and the Assurance of it; and the Comfort of that Assurance, and the continuation and Strength of that Comfort, according as her Necessity should require. Afterwards she prayed herself, and continued a pretty Space.

60. When Prayers were ended, she called to her Father and Mother, and demanded of them, whether she had at any Time anger'd or griev'd them. or done any Thing that did not become her? and begged of them to forgive her.

61. They

61. They answered her, that if all Children had carried themselves so to their Parents as she had done, there would be less Grief and Sorrow on all Hands than there is; and that if any such Thing had escaped thee, we would forgive it with all our Hearts, you have done as became a good Child.

62. Her Heart being quieted with her Peace with God and her Parents, she began to dispose of her Books; particularly she intreated her Mother to keep Mr. *De Witt's* Catechise Lectures as long as she lived, for her sake, and let my little Sister have my other Books, as my Remembrance.

63. Then (said she) she felt her Breast exceedingly pained, by which she knew that her End was very nigh. Her Father spoke to her as he was able, telling her the Lord would be her Strength in the Hour of her Necessity.

64. Yea, said she, The Lord is my Shepherd, although I pass through the Valley of the Shadow of Death, I will not fear, for thou art with me, thy Rod and thy Staff, they comfort me: And it is said, The Sufferings of this present Life are not worthy to be compared with the Glory that shall be revealed in us. Shall I not suffer and endure, seeing my glorious Redeemer was pleased to suffer so much for me? O how was He mocked and crowned with Thorns, that he might purchase a Crown of Righteousness for us: And that is the Crown of which *Paul* spoke, when he said, I have fought the good Fight, I have finished my Course, I have kept the Faith; henceforth there is laid up for me a Crown of Righteousness, which the Lord the righteous Judge shall give unto me in that Day; and not only unto me, but to all that love his appearing

65. Ye are bought with a Price, therefore glorify God with your Souls and Bodies, which are his. Must I not then exalt and bless Him while I have a Being, who hath bought me with his Blood? Surely he hath borne our Grievs, and took our Infirmities, and we esteemed him smitten and stricken of God: But he was wounded for our Transgressions, and bruised for our Sins: The Chastisement of our Peace was upon Him, and by his Stripes we are healed; and the Lord laid upon Him the Iniquity of us all. Behold the Lamb of God that taketh away the Sins of the World: That Lamb is Jesus Christ, who hath satisfied for my Sins. So saith *Paul*, Ye

are washed, ye are sanctified, ye are justified in the Name of the Lord Jesus Christ, and through the Spirit of our God.

66. My End is now very near, now I shall put on the white Raiment, and be cloathed with the Blood of the Lamb, that spotless Lamb, and with his spotless Righteousness. Now are the Angels making ready to carry my Soul before the Throne of God. These are they who are come out of great Tribulation, who have washed their Robes, and made them white in the Blood of the Lamb.

67. She spoke this with a dying Voice, but full of Spirit, and of the Power of Faith.

68. Her lively Assurance she further uttered in the Words of the Apostle, We know that if this earthly House of our Tabernacle be dissolved, we have one which is built of God, which is eternal in the Heavens; for in this, we sigh for our House which is in Heaven, that we may be cloathed therewith.

69. There, Father, you see that my Body is this Tabernacle, which now shall be broken down; my Soul shall now part from it and be taken up into that heavenly Paradise, into that heavenly Jerusalem. There shall I dwell and go no more out, but sit and sing, Holy, holy holy, is the Lord God of Hosts, the Lord of Sabaoth! Her last Words were these: O Lord God, into thy Hands I commit my Spirit, O Lord be gracious, be merciful to me a poor Sinner. — And here she fell asleep.

70. She died the first of September 1664, betwixt seven and eight in the Evening. in the fourteenth Year of her Age; having obtained that which she so oft intreated of the Lord a quiet and easy Departure, and the End of her Faith, the Salvation of her Soul.

EXAMPLE XII.

Of the excellent Carriage of a Child upon his Death-Bed, when but Seven Years old.

1. **J**ACOB Bicks, the Brother of *Susannah Bicks*, was born in *Leiden*, in the Year 1657; and had a religious Education, under his godly Parents, which the Lord was pleased to sanctify to his Conversion, and by it lay in excellent Provisions to live upon in an Hour of Distress.

2. This

2. This sweet little Child was visited of the Lord of a very sore Sickness, upon the sixth of August 1664, three or four Weeks before his Sister, of whose Life and Death we have given some Account already. In this Distemper he was for the most part very sleepy and drowsy, till near his Death, but when he did awake, he was wont still to fall a praying.

3. Once when his Parents had prayed with him, they asked him if they should once more send for the Physician? No (said he) I will have the Doctor no more; the Lord will help me; I know he will take me to Himself, and then he shall help all.

4. Ah my dear Child, said his Father, that grieveth my Heart. Well, (said the Child) Father let us pray, and the Lord shall be near for my Helper.

5. When his Parents had prayed with him again, he said, Come now dear Father and Mother, and kiss me, I know that I shall die.

6. Farewel dear Father and Mother. Farewel dear Sister. Farewel all. Now shall I go to Heaven unto God and Jesus Christ, and the holy Angels: Father, know you not what is said by Jeremiah; Blessed is he who trusteth in the Lord. Now I trust in him, and he will bless me. And in 1 John 2. It is said, Little Children, love not the World, for the World passeth away.

7. Away then all that is in the Word, away with all my pleasant Things in the World; away with my Dagger, for where I go, there is nothing to do with Daggers and Swords: Men shall not fight there, but praise God. Away with all my Books; there shall I know sufficiently, and be learned in all Things of true Wisdom, without Books.

8. His Father being touched to hear his Child speak at this Rate, could not well tell what to say; but my dear Child, the Lord will be near thee, and uphold thee

9. Yea, Father (said he) the Apostle Peter saith, God resisteth the Proud, but he giveth Grace to the Humble. I shall humble my self under the mighty Hand of God, and he shall help and lift me up

10. O my dear Child, said his Father, hast thou so strong a Faith?

11. Yes,

11. Yes, said the Child, God hath given me so strong a Faith upon Himself through Jesus Christ that the Devil himself shall flee from me, for it is said, *He that believeth in the Son hath everlasting Life, and he hath overcome the wicked One.* Now I believe in Jesus Christ my Redeemer, and he will not leave or forsake me, but shall give unto me eternal Life, and then shall I sing, *Holy, holy, holy, is the Lord of Sabbath.*

12. Then with a short Word of Prayer, *Lord be merciful to me a Sinner,* he quietly breathed out his Soul, and sweetly slept in Jesus, when he was about Seven Years old. He died August the 8th 1664.

H A L L E L U J A H.

E X A M P L E XIII.

Of one who began to look towards Heaven, when he was very young, with many eminent Passages of his Life, and his joyfull Death, when he was 11 Years and three Quarters old.

1. **J**ohn Harvy was born in London, in the Year 1654. His Father was a Dutch Merchant. He was piously educated under his virtuous Mother; and soon began to suck in divine Things with no small Delight.

2. The first Thing very observable in him was, that when he was two Years and nine Months old, he could speak as well as other Children do usually at five Years old.

3. His Parents judging that he was then a little too young to send out to School, let him have his Liberty to play a little about the Yard. But instead of playing, he found out a School of his own Accord hard by Home, and went to the School-Mistress, and intreated her to teach him to read, and so went for some Time to School without the Knowledge of his Parents, and made a very strange Progress in his Learning, and was able to read distinctly, before most Children are able to know their Letters.

4. He was wont to ask many serious and weighty Questions about Matters which concerned his Soul and Eternity.

5. His Mother being greatly troubled upon the Death of one of his Uncles, this Child came to his Mother and said

“ Mother,

Mother, tho' my Uncle be dead, doth not the Scripture say : must rise again? Yea, and I must die, and so must every body; and it will not be long before Christ will come to judge the World; and then we shall see one another again, pray, Mother, do not weep so much." This grave Counsel e gave to his Mother, when he was not quite five Years old, y which her Sorrow for her Bro'her was turned into Admiration at her Child, and she was made to sit silent and quiet nder that smarting Rod.

6. After this, his Parents removed to *Aberdeen* in *Scotland*, and settled their Child under an able and painful School-Master there, whose custom was, upon the Lord's Day in the Morning, to examine his Scholars concerning the Sermons hat they had heard the former Lord's-Day, and to add some other Questions which might try the Understanding and Knowledge of his Scholars; the Question that was once proposed to his Form was, *Whether God had a Mother?* None of all the Scholars could answer it, till it came to *John Harvey*, who being asked, *Whether God had a Mother?* answered, *No, as He was God, He could not have a Mother; but as He was Man He had.* This was before he was quite six Years old. His Master being somewhat amazed at the Child's Answer, took the first Opportunity to go to his Mother, to thank her for instructing her Son so well; but she replied, that he was never taught that from her, but that he understood it by Reading and his own Observation.

7. He was a Child that was extraordinary inquisitive, and full of good Questions, and very careful to observe and remember what he heard.

8. He had a great Hatred of whatsoever he knew to be displeasing to God, and was so greatly concerned for the Honour of God, that he would take on bitterly if any-gross Sins were committed before him. And he had a deep Sense of the Worth of Souls, and was not a little grieved when he saw any do that which he knew was dangerous to their Souls.

9. One Day seeing one of his near Relations come into his Father's House distempered with Drink, as he thought, he quickly went very seriously to him, and wept over him, that he should so offend God, and hazard his Soul, and begged of

of him to spend his Time better than in Drinking and Gaming ; and this he did without any Instruction from his Parents, but from an inward Principle of Grace, and Love to God and Souls, as it is verily believed.

10. When he was at play with other Children, he would be oftentimes putting in some Word to keep them from naughty Talk or wicked Actions; and if any did take the Lord's Name in vain, or do any Thing that was not becoming of a good Child, they should soon hear of it with a Witness; nay, once hearing a Boy speak very prophaneſy, and that after two or three Admonitions, he would not forbear, nor go out of his Company neither, he was ſo tranſported with Zeal, that he could not forbear falling upon him to beat him, but his Mother chiding him for it, he ſaid that he could not endure to hear the Name of God ſo abuſed by a wretched Boy.

11. He was a Child that took great Delight in the Company of good Men, and eſpecially Miniſters and Scholars; and if he had any leiſure Time, he would improve it by viſiting of ſuch, whoſe Diſcourſe might make him wiſer and better; and when he was in their Society, to be ſure, his Talk was more like a Chriſtian and Scholar than a Child.

12. One Day after School time was over, he gave Mr. *Andrew Kant* (one of the Miniſters of *Aberdeen*) a Viſit, and aſked him ſeveral ſolid Queſtions, but the good Man aſked him ſome Queſtions out of his Catechiſm, and finding him not ſo ready in the Anſwers as he ſhould have been, did a little reprove him, and told him, that he muſt be ſure to get his Catechiſm perfectly by Heart: The Child took the Reproof very well, and went Home and ſell very hot upon his Catechiſm, and never left, till he had got it by Heart; and not only ſo, but he would be enquiring into the Senſe and Meaning of it.

13. He was ſo greatly taken with his Catechiſm, that he was not content to learn it himſelf, but he would be putting others upon learning their Catechiſm eſpecially thoſe that were neareſt him; he could not be ſatisfied, till he had perſwaded his Mother's Maids to learn it; and when they were at Work, he would be following them with ſome good

Queſtion

Question or other; so that the Child seemed to be taken up with the Thoughts of his Soul and God's Honour and the good of other Souls.

14. He was a conscientious observer of the Lord's Day, spending all the Time either in secret Prayer, or reading the Scriptures, and good Books; Learning of his Catechism, and hearing the Word of God, and publick Duties; and was not only careful in the Performance of these Duties himself, but was ready to put all that he knew upon a strict Observation of the Lord's Day, and exceedingly grieved at the Profanation of it. One Lord's Day, a Servant of his Father's going out of the House upon extraordinary Occasion, to fetch some Beer, he took on so bitterly that he could scarce be pacified; because that holy Day was so abused (as he judged) in his Father's House.

15. When was between six and seven Years old it pleased God to afflict him with sore Eyes, which was no small grief to him, because it kept him from School which he loved as well as many Boys do their Play; and that which was worse he was commanded by the Doctor not to read any Book whatsoever at Home. But O how was this poor Child grieved, that it might not have Liberty to read the holy Scriptures; and for all their Charge, he would get by himself, and stand by the Window and read the Bible and good Books; yea, he was so greedy of reading the Scriptures, and took so much Delight in them, that he would scarce allow Time to dress himself; for reading the Word of God was his great Delight. Yea, tho' he had been beat for studying so much, yet judging it God's Command, that he should give himself up to reading, he could not be beat off from it till he was so bad, that he had like never to have recovered his Sight more.

16. It was his Practice to be much by himself in secret Prayer, and he was careful to manage that Work, so as that it might be as secret as possible it could be, but his frequency and constancy made it to be easily observed; upon which one Time, one having a great Mind to know what this sweet Babe prayed for, got into a Place near him, and heard him very earnestly praying for the Church of God, desiring that the Kingdom of the Gospel might be spread over the whole World, and that the Kingdom of Grace might more and more

come into the Hearts of God's People, and that the Kingdom of Glory might be hastned. He was wont to continue half an Hour, sometimes an Hour together upon his Knees.

17. He was much above the Vanities that most Children are taken with, and was indeed too much a Man to live long.

18. He was very humble and modest, and did by no Means affect fineness in Apparel, but hated any Thing more than Necessaries, either in Cloaths or Diet.

19. When he perceived either his Brother or Sisters pleased with their new Cloaths, he would with a great deal of Gravity reprove their Folly; and when his Reproof signified little, he would bewail their Vanity.

20. Once he had a new Suit brought from the Taylor's, which when he looked on, he found some Ribbons at the Knees, at which he was grieved; asking his Mother, Whether those Things would keep him warm? No Child, said the Mother. Why then (said he) do you suffer them to be put here; you are mistaken, if you think such Things please me; and I doubt some that are better than us, may want the Money that this cost you, to buy them Bread.

21. He would intreat his Mother to have a Care of gratifying a proud Humour in his Brother and Sisters; he did tell them of the Danger of Pride, and how little Reason they had to be proud of that which was their Shame; for said he, If it had not been for Sin, we should have had no need of Cloaths.

22. At leisure Times, he would be talking to his School-Fellows about the Things of God, and urge the Necessity of a holy Life. That Text he much spoke on to them, The Axe is laid to the Root of the Tree, and every Tree that bringeth not forth good Fruit is hewn down and cast into the Fire. Every Mother's Child of us that doth not bring forth the Fruit of good Works, shall shortly be cut down with the Axe of God's Wrath, and cast into the Fire of Hell; and this he spoke like one that believed and felt the Power of what he spake, and not with the least Visibility of a childish Levity of Spirit. This was when he was between seven and eight Years old, and if he perceived any Children unconcerned about their Souls, he would be greatly troubled at it.

23. After this, his Parents removed not far from London, where he continued 'till that dreadful Year Sixty-five : He was then sent to the Latin-School, where he soon made a great Progress, and was greatly beloved of his Master, the School was his beloved Place, and Learning his Recreation. He was never taught to write, but took it of his own Ingenuity.

24. He was exceeding dutiful to his Parents, and never did in the least dispute their Commands, except, when he thought they might cross the Commands of God, as in the forementioned Business of reading the Scriptures, when his Eyes were so bad.

25. He was exceedingly contented with any mean Diet, and to be sure he would not touch a Bit of any Thing, 'till he had begged God's Blessing upon it.

26. He would put his Brother and Sisters upon their Duties, and observe them whether they performed it or no, and when he saw any neglect, he would soon warn them ; if he saw any of them take a Spoon into their Hands before they had craved a Blessing, he said, That is just like a Hog indeed.

27. His Sister was afraid of the Darkeness, and would sometimes cry, upon this Account ; he told her, She must fear God more, and she need then be afraid of nothing.

28. He would humbly put his near Relations upon their Duty, and minding the Concerns of their Souls and Eternity, with more Seriousness and Life ; and to have a care of doing that which was for the Dishonour of God, and the Hazard of the Soul.

29. He was of a compassionate Disposition, and very pitiful to the Poor, or any that were in Distress ; but his greatest Pity was to poor Souls ; and as well as he could, he would be putting Children, Play-Fellows, Servants and Neighbours, upon minding their poor Souls.

30. One notable Instance of his true Charity I cannot omit. A certain Turk was by the Providence of God cast into the Place where he lived, which this sweet Child hearing of, had a great Pity to his Soul, and studied how he might be any way instrumental to do it good ; at last, finding a Man that understood the Language of the Turk, he used Means to get them together, which he at last procured ; the first Thing that

he did was to put his Friend upon discoursing with the Turk about his Principles whether he acknowledged a Deity; which the Turk owning, the next Thing he enquired after was, What he thought of the Lord Jesus Christ? At which the Turk was troubled, and put off the Discourse, and said he was athirst, and an hungry; which the Child being informed of by the Interpreter, immediately went to a Brew-House near at Hand (his own House being far off) and did intreat the Master of the Brew-House to give him some Beer for the Turk, and the Argument he used was this, *Sir, here is a poor Stranger that is athirst; we know not where we may be cast before we die.* He went to another Place, and begged Food for him; using the same Argument as before. But his Friends hearing of it, were angry with him, but he told them he did it for a poor Stranger that was far from Home; and he did it, that he might think the better of Christians, and the Christian Religion.

31. He would have a savoury Word to say to every one he conversed with, to put them in Mind of the Worth of Christ and their Souls, and their nearness to Eternity. Insomuch, that good People took no small Pleasure in his Company. The Taylor that made his Cloaths, would keep them longer before he brought them Home, that he might have the Benefit of his spiritual and christian Society; and more frequent Visits.

32. He bewailed the miserable Condition of the Generality of Mankind (when he was about ten Years old) that they were utterly estranged from God, though they called him Father, yet they were his Children only by Creation, and not by any Likeness they had to God or Interest in Him.

33. Thus he continued walking in the Ways of God, engaged in reading, praying, hearing the Word of God and spiritual Discourses, discovering thereby his serious Thoughts of Eternity.

34. He had an earnest desire if it might be the Lord's good Pleasure, to give himself up to the Lord in the Work of the Ministry, if he should live; and this out of a dear Love to Christ and Souls.

35. He was next to the Bible, most taken with reading of the Rev. Mr. Baxter's Works, especially his *Saints Everlasting*

lasting Rest; and truly the Thoughts of that Rest and Eternity seemed to swallow up all other Thoughts; and he lived in a constant Preparation for it, and looked more like one that was ripe for Glory, than an Inhabitant of this lower World.

36. When he was about eleven Years and three Quarters old his Mother's House was visited with the Plague; his eldest Sister was the first that was visited with this Dissemper, and when they were praying for her, he would sob and weep bitterly.

37. As soon as he perceived that his Sister was dead, he said, The Will of the Lord be done: Blessed be the Lord. Dear Mother, said he, you must do as David did, after the Child was dead, he went and refreshed himself, and quietly submitted himself to the Will of God.

38. The rest of the Family held well for about fourteen Days, which Time he spent in religious Duties, and preparing for his Death: but still his great Book was, *The Saints Rest*; which he read with exceeding Curiosity gathering many Observations out of it in Writing for his own Use. He wrote several divine Meditations of his own upon several Subjects; but that which seemed most admirable, was a Meditation upon the Excellency of Christ: He was never well but when he was more immediately engaged in the Service of God.

39. At fourteen Days End, he was taken sick, at which he seemed very patient and chearful, yet sometimes he would say his Pain was great.

40. His Mother looking upon his Brother, shook her Head; at which he asked if his Brother were marked; she answered, Yea Child, he asked again, whether he were marked: she answered nothing: Well, says he, I know I shall be marked; I pray let me have Mr. Baxter's Book, that I may read a little more of Eternity, before I go into it. His Mother told him, That he was not able to read: He said that he was; however then, pray by me and for me. His Mother answered, she was so full of Grief, that she could not pray now; but desired to hear him pray his last Prayer.

41. His Mother asked him, whether he were willing to die, and leave her? He answered, Yes, I am willing to leave you, and go to my heavenly Father. His Mother answered, Child, if thou hadst but an Assurance of God's Love, I should not be so much troubled:

42. He answered, and said to his Mother, I am assured Dear Mother, that my Sins are forgiven, and that I shall go to Heaven; for, said he, here stood an Angel by me, that told me, that I should quickly be in Glory.

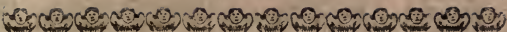
43. At this his Mother burst forth in Tears. *O Mother, said he, did you but know what Joy I feel, you would not weep but rejoice. I tell you I am so full of Comfort, that I can't tell you how I am: O Mother, I shall presently have my Head in my Father's Bosom, and shall be where the four and twenty Elders shall cast down their Crowns, and sing Hallelujah, Glory and Praise, to him that sits upon the Throne, and unto the Lamb forever.*

44. Upon this, his Speech began to fail him, but his Soul seemed still to be taken up with Glory, and nothing now grieved him but the Sorrow that he saw his Mother to be in for his Death: A little to divert his Mother, he asked her, *What she had to Supper?* but presently in a Kind of divine Rapture, he cried out, *O what a sweet Supper have I making ready for me in Glory!*

45. But seeing all this rather increase than allay his Mother's Grief, he was more troubled, and asked her what she meant, thus to offend God; know you not that it is the Hand of the Almighty? *Humble yourself under the mighty Hand of God. Lay yourself in the Dust, and kiss the Rod of God, and let me see you do it, in Token of your Submission to the Will of God, and bow before Him.* Upon which, raising himself a little, he gave a lowly Bow, and spake no more, but went chearfully and triumphantly to Rest, in the Bosom of JESUS.

H A L L E L U J A H.





A NARRATIVE of sundry remarkable Passages concerning Mr. *John Langham*, Son of Sir JAMES LANGHAM, Knight and Baronet.*

By THOMAS BURROUGHS, B.D.

THIS sweet Child was *five Years* and an *half* old within two or three Days, when God took him: But he had arrived to that in *five Years* and a little more, that some (I am afraid) have not arrived to in ten Times the Space.

He had learnt the *Assembly's shorter Catechism* through, and began to learn it over again, with the Proofs out of the Scriptures at large, wherein he had made some Progress.

He met one Day (in a Gentlewoman's Chamber, who lives in the House) with a Book that treated of the *Passion of CHRIST*, and reading a little in it, said he liked the Book well, and that he would read it over. So he began and read some few Pages, then turned the Leaf down, and the next Day came again and began where he left, and so from Day to Day, till he had read a considerable Part of it.

He was a very dutiful Child to his Parents, and would exceedingly rejoice, when he had done any Thing, or carried himself so, as to please them.

He was taken with a Book called *The Practice of Piety*, and delighted to be reading in it.

He

* He died July 29, 1659.

His Father speaking to him one Day about the Devil and Hell, and Things of that Nature, asked him, If he were not afraid to be alone? He answered, *No: For God would defend him.* His Father asked him, Why he thought so? He replied, that *He loved God, and that he hoped that God loved him.* But (saith his Father) you have been a Sinner, and God loves not Sinners. *But I am sorry for my Sins* (saith he) *and do repent —* Repent (eplied his Father) do you know what Repentance means, and what belongs to it? And he gave him a good Account of the Apprehension he had of the Nature of that Grace, according to what he had learned in his Catechism, but yet in his own Words and Expressions.

He would often ask his Sister (who was somewhat younger than himself) *Whether she trusted in God, and loved God?* and would tell her, that, *If she sought God, God would be found of her; but if she forsook God, God would cast her off for ever.*

He took that Deight in his Book, that his Father and Mother have seen Cause sometimes to hide away his Book from him.

He was never observed to discover any Pouting or Discontent, when upon any Occasion he was corrected. For you must not think I am telling you the Story of one in whom *Adam* (as they seign *Bonaventure*) never sinned. There is that *Foolishness* bound up in all Children's Hearts, that will sometimes need the Rod of Correction; tho' there be very few in whom there appeared less than in him.

The Day before he died, he desired me to pray for him; I told him, If he would have me to pray for him, he must tell me, what I should pray for; and what he would have God do for him! He answered, *To pardon his Sins.*

Of upon his sick Bed he would be repeating to himself the 55th Chapter of *Isaiah*, and other Places of Scripture, which in the Time of his Health he had learned by Heart.

But that Passage in the forementioned Chapter was most frequently in his Mouth, and uttered by him with much Affection: *My Thoughts are not your Thoughts, neither are my Ways your Ways, saith the Lord: For as the Heavens are higher than the Earth, so are my Ways and my Thoughts than your Thoughts:* As if God (out of this sweet Babe's Mouth) had, in these Words, read to his Parents a Lecture of Silence and Submission under *his Hand*; and taught them that he must be dealt with and disposed of, not as they, but as their heavenly Father (whose Thoughts were far different) should see fitting.

One Time he brake out into this Expression; *My God, my God, deliver me out of this Misery, and from the Pains of Hell for ever.*

A little before his Death he brake out into these Words; *My Sins pardon, my Soul save, for Christ his Sake.*

I cannot blame those worthy Persons so nearly related to him, tho' they mourn at parting with such a sweet and hopeful Child; any more than I could blame them for feeling Pain, if one of their Limbs were torn from another. Only they must not mourn to Despondency.

What an Instrument of God's Glory might he have proved? What a deal of Service might he have done for God (in all Likelihood) had he lived to old Age? But it was God's doing.

The END of the SECOND PART.



A
T O K E N
F O R T H E
C H I L D R E N
O F
N E W - E N G L A N D .

*I*F the Children of New-England should not with an Early Piety, set themselves to Know and Serve the Lord JESUS CHRIST, the GOD of their Fathers, they will be condemned, not only by the Examples of pious Children in other Parts of the World, the published and printed Accounts whereof have been brought over hither; but there have been Exemplary Children in the midst of New-England itself, that will rise up against them for their Condemnation. It would be a very profitable thing to our Children, and highly acceptable to all the godly Parents of the Children, if, in Imitation of the excellent JANEWAY'S Token for Children, there were made a true Collection of notable Things, exemplified in the Lives and Deaths of many among us, whose Childhood hath been signalized for what is virtuous and laudable.

In the Church History of New-England is to be found the Lives of many eminent Persons, among whose Eminencies, not the least was, their fearing of the Lord from their Youth, and their being loved by the Lord when they were Children.

But among the many other Instances of a Childhood and Youth delivered from Vanity by serious Religion, which New-England has afforded, these few have particularly been preserved.

E X A M P L E I.

✠ L ✠ LITTLE more than Thirteen Years old was JOHN CLAP, of *Scituate*, when he dy'd ; but it might very truly be said of him, *That while he was yet Young, he began to seek after the God of his Father.* From his Infancy he discovered a singular Delight in the Holy Scriptures, whereby he was made *wise unto Salvation* ; and he also made himself yet further amiable by his *Obedience* to his Parents, and his *Courtesy* to all his Neighbours. As he grew up, he signalized his Concern for Eternity, not only by his diligent Attendance upon both publick and private *Gatechising* but also by the like Attendance on the *Ministry of the Word*, which he would ponder and apply, and confer about with much Discretion of Soul, and *pray* for the good Effect thereof upon his own Soul. Yea, 'twas even from his Childhood observable in him, that ever after he began to speak reasonably, he would both affectionately regard the *Family Prayers*, and likewise, both Morning and Evening, with a most unwearied Constancy, recommend himself by his own Prayers unto the Mercies of God.

Arriving higher into his Age, he was very conscientious of his Duty both to God and Man : and particularly careful of his Father's *Business*, which now became his own *Calling*. At Work with his Father in the Field, he would frequently be propounding of *Questions*, by the Answers of which he might be promoted in the Knowledge of God ; and at the Seasons which others usually employ to vain Purposes, he would be abounding in the Exercises of Devotion. But of all the imitable Things to be seen in him, he was exemplary for nothing more than his Endeavours in *Preparation*

for, and *Sanctification* of, the *Lord's-Day*. Yea, his Parents have affirmed, that for a Year or two before he dy'd, *They nev-r heard an unprofitable Word come out of his Mouth*; but he would often bewail the idle, trifling, vain Discourses of other People.

About a Year and a half before he died, the good Spirit of God blessed him with yet a more thorough Conviction of his Misery by Reason of *Sin*, both *Original* and *Actual*: Whence, though he had been such a *Pattern* of *Innocency*, yet he would aggravate his own *Sinfulness*, with Lamentations truly extraordinary.— And for his Relief against the *Terrors* of God, where-with he was now *distracted* he was brought unto an utter Despair of his own Righteousnesses and Abilities; but in this Condition, he came to adore the Grace of God offering a JESUS who is *able to save unto the uttermost*: In his Longings to enjoy the Love of God, through *Jesus*, he was like the *Hart panting after the Water-Brooks*!

The Wounds of his *Spirit* were accompanied with a languishing and consuming of his *flesh*: yet with great Patience he endured the Hand of God, and he followed the Lord with *Prayers*, with *Gries*, with *Tears*, for the Manifestation of the Divine Love unto him.

It was also observed and admired, that when he was abroad at the publick Worship, in the Time of his Weakness, he would *stand* the whole Time of the long Exercises, and be so affectionately attentive that one might see every Sentence uttered in those Exercises make some Impression upon him. The best *Christians* in the Place professed themselves made ashamed by the Fervency of this *young Disciple*! And in Days of publick *Humiliations*, or *Thanksgivings*, kept with Regard unto the general Circumstances of the Country, he would bear his Part, with such a Sense of the publick *Troubles*, or *Mercies*, as argued more than a common Measure of a public Spirit in him.

The Minister of the Place, visiting of him, after Sickness had confined him, found him in extrem
Dejection

Dejection of Soul; his very Body shook, through his Fear, lest the *Day of Grace* was over with him; yet justifying of God, though he should lie for ever among the Damned. But yet his *Fears* were accompanied with *Hopes* in the sufficient Merits of the blessed *Jesus*; in which *Hopes* he continued using all the *Means of Grace*, according to his Capacity, and lamenting after those whereof he was not capable.

A Month before he died he kept his Bed; the first Fortnight whereof he was very comfortless, and yet very patient; abounding all this while in gracious Admonitions unto other young People, that they would be concerned for their own eternal Salvation. And you should not now have heard him complain, that he wanted Health and Ease, though he did so; but that he wanted *Faith*, and *Peace*, and *Christ*; yet expressing a profound Submission to the Will of God.

But in the last Fortnight of his Life, this poor Child of God had his weary Soul more comfortably satiated with the *Promises* of the *New-Covenant*. God filled him with a marvellous Assurance of his Love, and so sealed him with his own Spirit, that he rejoiced with Joy unspeakable and full of Glory. He would often be saying, *Whom have I in Heaven but thee? and there is none on Earth that I desire besides thee: My Flesh and my Heart faileth, but God is the Strength of my Heart, and my Portion for ever. And, I know that my Redeemer lives, and that he shall stand at the latter Day upon the Earth. And, If I live, I shall live unto the Lord; if I die, I shall die unto the Lord; and whether I live or die, I am the Lord's. And, When Christ, who is my Life, shall appear, then shall I also appear with him in Glory.* He would profess, that his Communion with the Lord Jesus Christ was inexpressible; and the Spectators judged his Consolations to be as great as could be borne, in a mortal Body. Being now asked, *Whether the Thoughts of dying troubled him not?* He replied, *No, Death is no Terror to me, because Christ has taken away my Sin,*
which

which is the Sting of Death. But being asked, *Whether he was willing to live?* He answered, *I am willing to submit unto the Will of God; but if God have appointed me to Life, I desire I may live to his Glory.* And being asked, *Whether God had put out of Doubt his Interest in a dying and rising Jesus?* He answered, *Yes; and God has fully answered my Desires, I am now going to a thousand Times better World.* He told his Mother, *I love you as dearly as my own Life, yet I had rather die, and be with Christ.*

He continued six Days with his Teeth so shut, as that they could not be opened; and for the first three Days and Nights, he took no Sustenance; afterwards, though this but seldom, he suck'd in between his Teeth, nothing but a little cold Water: In which Time, they that laid their Ears to his Lips, could over-hear him continually expressing his Comfort in God. But just before his Death, his Teeth were opened; when he would often say, *Oh! how precious is the Blood of Christ, it is worth more than a Thousand Worlds!* and often pray, *Come, Lord Jesus, come quickly!* And at last, he gave up himself to God, in those Words, *Lord Jesus, receive my Spirit.* He desired his Mother to turn his Face unto the Wall; whereupon she said, *John, dost thou now remember Hezekiah's turning his Face unto the Wall?* He said, *Yes, I do remember it?* and as she turned him in her Arms, he quietly breathed his Soul into the Arms of his blessed Saviour.

[*Extracted out of the Account written and printed by Mr. Witheril and Mr. Baker, Ministers of Scituate, and prefaced by Mr. Urian Oakes; who takes that Occasion to say of this John Clap, He was a young old Man, full of Grace, though not full of Days.*]

EXAMPLE II.

MR. Thomas Thornton, the aged and faithful Pastor of Yarmouth, was blessed with a Daughter, named *Priscilla*, which at the Age of Eleven left this World, having first given Demonstrations of an exemplary Piety. She

She was one remarkably grave, devout, serious; very inquisitive about the Matters of Eternity; and in her particular Calling very diligent. She was, nevertheless, troubled with sore Temptations and Exercises about the State of her own Soul; the Anguish of her Spirit about the *Body of Death*, caused her to pour out many Tears and Prayers; and she pressed, that some other pious Children of her Acquaintance, might with her keep a Day of Humiliation together: *That* (as she expressed it) *they might get power against their sinful Nature*. But it pleased God at length to bless the Words of her godly Mother, for the quieting of her Mind. It was her singular Happiness, that she had such godly Parents; but it was her Opinion and Expression, *We trust too much to the Prayers of our Parents, whereas we should pray for ourselves*.

At last, she fell mortally sick. In the Beginning of her Sickness, she was afraid of dying: *For*, said she, *I know of no Promise to encourage me*. She could not but own that she had in some Measure walked with God; yet she complained, That she had not found God meeting her in her Prayers, and making her Heart willing to be at his Disposal; and that the Pride of her Heart now lay as a Load upon it. She owned, That she had many Thoughts of Jesus Christ, and that it grieved her that she had sinned against him, who had *done and dy'd* for her.

But many Days were not past, before she could profess herself *Willing to Die*, with some Assurance of her then going into eternal Blessedness. Many Thanks and Loves did she now render to some of her Superiors, declaring, *'Twas because they had curb'd her, and restrain'd her from sinful Vanities*. And she said, *Were I now to choose my company, it should be among the People of God; I see plainly that they are the only Company*. She was not without her Conflicts in this Time; wherein one of her Speeches was, *Damnation, that is the worst Thing of all, but Christ is of all the best: I find it so; Christ is to me Wisdom, Righteousness, Sanctification,*
and

and Redemption. She told her Father she knew she was made up of all Manner of Sin; but, said she, *I hope God has humbled me, and pardoned me in the Merits of the Lord Jesus Christ.* Unto her affectionate Mother she said, *Mother, why do you weep, when I am well in my Soul? Will you mourn, when I am so full of Joy? I pray rejoice with me.*

When she was extremely spent, she said unto her Parents, *O my Father, I have been much troubled by Satan, but I find Christ is too hard for him, and Sin, and all.* She now said, *I know now, that I shall die;* and being asked, Whether she were afraid of Death? with a sweet Smile she replied, *No, not I, Christ is better than Life!* And so she continued in a most joyful Frame, till she died: a little before which it being the Lord's Day, she asked, What time of the Day 'twas? and when they told her, 'Twas Three of the Clock, she replied, What is the Sabbath almost done? Well, my Eternal Sabbath is a going to begin, wherein I shall enjoy all Felicity, and sing Hallelujahs to all Eternity. And hereupon she quickly fell asleep in the Lord.

EXAMPLE III.

MR. NATHANAEL MATHER died Octob. 17. 1688. at the Age of Nineteen, an Instance of more than common Learning and Virtue. On his Grave-Stone at *Salem*, there are these Words deservedly inscribed, **THE ASHES OF AN HARD STUDENT, A GOOD SCHOLAR, AND A GREAT CHRISTIAN.**

He was one who used an extraordinary Diligence to obtain Skill in the several Arts that make an accomplished Scholar: but he was more diligent in his Endeavours to become an experienced Christian.

He did with much of Solemnity enter into COVENANT with GOD, when he was about Fourteen Years old. And afterwards he renewed that solemn Action, in such a Form as this:

' I do renounce all the Vanities and wretched Idols and evil Courses of the World.

' I do choose, and will ever have, the great GOD, for my best Good, my last End, my only Lord. He shall be the only One, in the Glorifying and Enjoying of whom shall be my Welfare; and in the Serving of whom shall be my Work.

' I will ever be rendering unto the Lord Jesus Christ, my proper acknowledgments, as unto my Priest, my Prophet, and my King, and the Physician of my Soul.

' I will ever be studying what is my Duty in these Things; and wherein I find myself to fall short, I will ever count it my Grief and Shame; and betake myself to the Blood of the Everlasting Covenant.

' Now humbly imploring the Grace of the Mediator to be sufficient for me, I do as a further Solemnity, hereunto subscribe my Name, with both Heart and Hand.'

Having done this, he did for the rest of his Life walk with much Watchfulness and Exactness.

One of the *Directories*, which he drew up for himself, was this:

' O that I might lead a *Spiritual Life*! Wherefore let me regulate my Life by the Word of God, and by such Scriptures as these,

' 1. For regulating my *Thoughts*, Jer. iv. 14. Isa. lv. 7. Psal. civ. 34.

' 2. For regulating my *Affections*, Col. iii. 1, 5. Gal. v. 24.

For my *Delight*, Psal. i. 2. For my *Joy*, Phil. iv. 4.

Psal. xliii. 4. My *Desire*, Isaiah ii. 6, 8, 9. My *Love*,

Matth. xxii. 37. My *Hatred*, Psal. xcvi. 10. My *Fear*,

Luke kit. 4, 5. My *Hope*, Psal. xxxix. 7. My *Trust*,

Psal. lxii. 8. Isa. xxvi. 4.

' 3. For regulating my *Speech*, Eph. iv. 29. Col. iv. 6. Deut. vi. 6, 7.

' 4. For regulating my *Work*, Tit. iii. 8. 1 Tim. v. 10.

Matth. v. 47.

Another of his *Directories* was formed into an *Hymn*.

- ‘ LORD, what shall I return unto
 ‘ Him from whom all my Mercies flow?
 ‘ (I.) To me to live, it CHRIST shall be,
 ‘ For all I do I’ll do for Thee.
 ‘ (II.) My Question shall be oft beside,
 ‘ *How thou may’st most be glorify’d.*
 ‘ (III.) I will not any Creature love,
 ‘ But in the Love of Thee above.
 ‘ (IV.) Thy Will I will embrace for mine;
 ‘ And every Management of thine
 ‘ Shall please me (V.) A Conformity
 ‘ To thee shall be my Aim and Eye.
 ‘ (VI.) Ejaculations shall ascend
 ‘ Not seldom from me. (VII.) I’ll attend
 ‘ Occasional Reflections, and
 ‘ Turn all to Gold that comes to Hand.
 ‘ (VIII.) And in particular among
 ‘ My Cares I’ll try to make my *Tongue*
 ‘ A *Tree of Life*, by speaking all
 ‘ As be accountable who shall.
 ‘ (IX.) But *last*, nay *first* of all. I will
 ‘ Thy Son my Surety make, and still
 ‘ Implore Him, that he would me bless
 ‘ With Strength as well as Righteousness.’

He would also keep *whole Days* of Prayer and Praise by himself: And he would set himself to consider much of that Question, *What shall I do for God?*

He was much in *Meditation*, and often wrote the chief Heads of his Meditation. He would read the Scripture, with a *Note*, and a *Wish*, fetched out of every Verse: And at Night, he would ask,

1. *What has God’s Mercy to me been this Day?*
2. *What has my Carriage to God been this Day?*
3. *If I die this Night, is my immortal Soul safe?*

Many more such imitable Things are in the History of his Life, divers Times printed in London.

EXAMPLE IV.

A NN GREENOUGH, the Daughter of Mr *William Greenough*, left the World, when she was but about five Years old and yet gave astonishing Discoveries of a Regard to God and Christ, and her own Soul, before she went away. When she heard any Thing about the Lord Jesus Christ, she would be strangely transported, and ravished in her Spirit at it; and had an unspeakable Delight in Catechising. She would put strange Questions about Eternal Things, and make Answers herself that were extremely pertinent. Once particularly she asked, Are not we dead in Sin? and presently added, But I will take this way, the Lord Jesus Christ shall make me alive. She was very frequent and constant in Secret Prayer, and could not with any Patience be interrupted in it. She told her gracious Mother, That she there prayed for her! And was covetous of being with her Mother, when she imagined such Duties to be going forward. When she fell sick at last of a Consumption, she would not by any Sports be diverted from the Thoughts of Death, where she took such Pleasure, that she did not care to hear of any Thing else. And if she were asked, Whether she were willing to die? She would still chearfully reply, Ah, by all Means, that I may go to the Lord Jesus Christ.

EXAMPLE V.

AT *Boston*, 12th day of the 3d month, 1694, there died one *Daniel Williams*, in the 18th Year of his Age. There was a Collection made of some of his dying Speeches.

Being asked, Whether he loved the Lord? He reply'd, Yea, I love Him dearly; for Lord, whom have I in Heaven but thee.

He said, God had promised, 'They that seek Him early shall find Him; Ever since I was a Child, I dedicated myself to seek the Lord.' Though I have not had so much Time as some others, yet that little Time which I had, I spent in waiting on, and wrestling with God by Prayer; and I said, I will not let thee go, 'till thou hast blessed me.'

Seeing some of his Relations weep, he said Why do you Cry, when I am ready to Sing for Joy?

They saying, They knew not how to part with him, he replied, Are you not willing I should go to my Heavenly Father? I shall quickly be with my Heaven'y Father, and with his holy Angels, where they are singing of Hallelujahs. It's better being there than here. When I am there, I shan't wish myself here, in this troublesome World again. I have a desire to depart and be with Christ, which is best of all.

He was much concerned for poor perishing Souls. He would say, 'Oh, that I had strength! How would I pray, and sigh, and cry to God, for the poor World that lives in Sin and Pride!'

He expressed himself most pathetically to his Relations, when he took his Leave of them.

At last, he asked, What Angel that was, that he saw before him? Well, said he, I shall be with him: Come, Lord Jesus, come quickly!

A Friend asking him how he did, he said 'I am one bound for Heaven. I would not have you pray for my Life; I am afraid you do!'

On the Day of his Death, being full of Pain, he said, 'Jesus Christ bore more than this, and He died for me; and shall I be afraid to die and go to him? No, I am not.'—Then said he, *O Death! where is thy Sting? O Grave! where is thy Victory?*

E X A M P L E VI.

Extract of a Letter from Southold, 23d 4th month, 1698.

I Have been requested to give you this Account from the Parents of a gracious Child, who in all her Life did comport herself to walk in the Lord's holy Fear, and gave a great Attention in hearing the Word of God, and the Lord was pleased to ripen her for Himself, tho' she was but fifteen Years and four Months old. Tho' she was Young, it pleased the Lord to put a great Fear and Awe upon her Heart of breaking the *fifth Commandment*. And when she was under the Dispensation of God in Sicknes, it pleased the Lord for to endue her with Patience, to be willing to bear his Hand with

with all Meekness. She confessed herself to be a great Sinner, and to have sinned against a gracious God. But the Lord vouchsafed her a strong Faith, to believe that he is a merciful God, and willing to forgive Sins, and that he had forgiven her Sins in the Blood of our blessed Saviour Jesus Christ. And, therefore, she was very willing to leave the World, and her Father and Mother, having Faith that she was going to Christ: These were her own Expressions. When her Mother did ask her, if she was willing to die, for she was too young to die: She some time before she died, said she was not fit to die, but prayed unto the Lord, that he would please to fit her and make her willing to die. *Oh, said she, Death comes unawares, it comes like a Thief in the Night?* The Lord granted her Desire: For afterwards, when her Mother asked her, *My Child are you willing to die?* Her Answer was, That now she was willing to die, and leave a thousand Worlds, and Father and Mother and all, to go to Christ. She desired that the Curtains might be drawn, that the Light of this World might not deprive her from beholding the Brightness and the Glory of the other World. And when she saw her Father and Mother weeping for her, she said, My dear Father and Mother, don't mourn for me; you might well mourn for me, if I were to go into utter Darkness; but I am going to God in Heaven. I long to be in the *New Jerusalem*, with the Lord Jesus Christ: And now I can die. And lying a while in an Agony, when she came out of that Agony, she said, Mother, did you not hear me sing? I thought I was in Heaven with the Lord Jesus Christ, and my Grand Parents, and the holy Angels, and heard such melodious Praises of God, as I never heard; and I was very sorry I could not sing like them. She said to her Relations, Oh, don't set your Hearts upon the World, nor look for the Honours and Riches of this World; but seek first the Kingdom of Heaven. She would call upon her Father to go to prayer at the Evening, and say, I cannot, I dare not go to sleep without it. She wished that some young People might come to her, to put them in mind to consider their latter End, and leave off their Pride. There came a young Maid to see her, and she said to her with

Tears,

' Tears, that she should not follow the Fashions of the World,
 ' and not put off Repentance to a sick Bed. Yea, she spake
 ' to all them that were about her, That they would not mind
 ' this World, but the other World. Her Mother asked her,
 ' if she was not afraid to lie in the Dust? But she was not
 ' thoughtful what should become of her Body, believing her
 ' Soul would go to God. Mother, said she, I could not sing
 ' here, but now I am going to sing the Praises of God in
 ' Heaven. Looking on her Father, she said, Oh, Father,
 ' there is no God like our God, for he is a God pardoning
 ' Iniquity, Transgression and Sin. She said I wonder how
 ' you do to live in such a troublesome evil and sinful World:
 ' Don't you see how the Judgments of God are all over the
 ' Earth. She often cried out, O Lord Jesus, Come: Let
 ' thine Angels come, and carry me to the Bosom of *Abraham*.
 ' This is a true Relation of this gracious Flower of the
 ' Lord Jesus Christ: She was an only Child: her Name was
 ' *Bethiab*, the Daughter of *Thomas* and *Mary Longworth*.

' The Lord raise up your Heart, to declare his wonderful
 ' Mercies, in working so graciously upon the Heart of such
 ' a young Flower; that the Lord may raise up more such
 ' gracious Souls in our rising Generation.'

E X A M P L E VII.

A notable Passage, transcribed from the Life of Mr. John
Baily, as related in a Sermon preached on the Day of his
Funeral, at Boston. By Dr. COTTON MATHER.

' FROM a Child he did know the holy Scriptures: Yea,
 ' FROM a Child he was *wise unto Salvation*. In his
 ' very Childhood he discovered the Fear of God upon his
 ' young Heart, and Prayer to God was one of his early
 ' Exercises.

' There was one very remarkable Effect of it, His Father
 ' was a Man of a very licentious Conversation; a Gamester,
 ' a Dancer, a very lewd Company-keeper. The Mother of
 ' this *Elect Vessel*, one Day took him, while he was yet a
 ' Child, and calling the Family together, made him to pray

' with

with them. His Father coming to understand at what Rate the Child had prayed with the Family, it smote the Soul of him with a great Conviction, and proved the Beginning of his Conversion unto God. God left not off working on his Heart, until he proved one of the most eminent Christians in that Neighbourhood. So he lived, so he died; a Man of more than ordinary Piety. And it was his Manner sometimes to retire unto those very Places of his Lewdnesses, where having that his little Son in his Company, he would pour out Floods of Tears in repenting Prayers before the Lord.

EXAMPLE VIII.

Of Daniel Bradly, the Son of Nathan Hester Bradly, of Guilford, in Connecticut, NEW-ENGLAND.

WHEN the said Child was about three Years old, he had one Night an Impression of the Fears of Death, which put him into crying: his Mother told him, if he died he would go to Heaven; unto which he replied, He knew not how to like that Place, where he should be acquainted with no body. After which, upon all occasions, he was inquisitive about the State of Souls after Death, and seemed to have real Apprehensions about it, according unto, if not beyond his Capacity.

The third Day Ague took him in his sixth Year, and held him near three Years: Some Months before his Death he had many greivous Pains, in which his Patience was very observable: yet he once felt a Pang of Impatience, so as to think it had been better he had never been born, yet he submitted to his Father's Reproof: after which he began to be assaulted sharply with the Fears of Death, and manifested strange Conceptions about the World to come. He could not see God, nor could he apprehend how he should love God better than his Parents, nor how God should love him, nor how he could live in Heaven, especially if his Parents were not there, or if he might not know them. He also expressed Difficulty to believe the Resurrection of the Body, and was continually asking his Mother Questions about Things

Things of this Nature, and how it could be, if he died and was eaten up of the Worms, he could live again. She then told him the Words of Job : And though after my Skin Worms destroy this Body, yet in my Flesh shall I see God : And if she told him any Thing that she heard or the good People so apprehended, or the like, it gave him little Content except she could assure him it was so in the Bible ; and that would always sit him down quiet. He told his Mother, that he thought the Reason why people read in the Bible, was that they might find out what God would have them to do ; and they prayed for what they would have God do for them. He was much troubled that he was not big enough to pray. His Father told him that Parents prayed for their Children ; but that did not satisfy him, 'till it was told him he was big enough to pray for himself ; and then he doubted he could not pray aright : His Mother told him he must pray according to his Ability, and God would accept it : Then he addressed himself to the Duty, and would have all go out of the Room except his Mother, and she to stay, that if he prayed what was not right, she might tell him ; then with great Solemnity he fixed his Eyes, and asked his Mother whether he should begin with that Expression (BLESSED GOD) which was not usual in the Beginning of Prayer in his hearing, and he manifesting some extraordinary realising Apprehensions of God, was exceeding affecting to his Mother. The Substance of his Prayer was, That he might live and be a Comfort to his Parents ; or if he must die, that God would own him, and love him, and help him to love God, and make him know how it should be with him in the World to come ; and desired to be willing to die when his Time came. After this he frequently was observed to pray, and desired to be alone for that End. One Time he had a great Sadness fell upon him, that lasted some Time before the Cause of it was known : But at last he told his Mother, God was always angry with him, and he was afraid to tell why, 'till she perswaded him ; and then he confessed, that he had been guilty of a Lie that he told, and should have told another, if he had not some Way been prevented, and that he doubted the Sin of that to him
was

was as great as if he went through with it: His Mother asked him, if he were sorry for it; he said he was formerly sorry for it, but now more than ever; his Mother told him, if he were sorry for it, God would have Mercy: He asked her whether it were so in the Bible; she told him, the Word was, He that confesseth and forsaketh his Sin, shall find Mercy: He said he knew what confessing was, but he did not understand forsaking; she said, it was to do so no more, that gave him some quiet; yet still Trouble and Fear of God's Anger hung about him: Then his Mother told him of Christ's Redemption, and of Sins being pardoned through him, and our Need of an Interest in that Redemption; at which he smiling and wondering asked, Whether it was certainly so, that Christ died for Man's Sake; he said he had never heard it before. She asked if he did not remember it had been read in the Family, or taught in the Catechism? He said he did not, but now greatly rejoiced in the Apprehension of Christ's Love so revealed.

After this he had a strong Pang of Temptation, and asked his Sister, whether she might not kill him? His Mother (being out of the Room) came in and reproved him for saying so sinful a Word. He asked how it appeared to be Sin, seeing he lived in so much Pain: She put him in Mind of Mr. Cotton's Explication of the sixth Command, that we are not to shorten the Lives of our selves or others, but preserve both; upon which he paused a while, and then desired his Mother to teach him the Catechism (which he had learnt before) and she did from the Beginning, until she came past that Question of the sixth Command, which he readily answered to; but then desired to go to that which was better. She asked him, what he meant? He answered whereabout it speaks of the eternal Son of God: she turned to that Part of the Catechism, and upon that Answer, Jesus Christ is the only Son of God, who for our sakes became Man, that he might redeem and save us. He lifted up his Hand, and said, it is enough, and so seemed to meditate thereon.

Also it was observed, that before and after his Sickneſs began, that he hath ſo dealt with and reprov'd grown Perſons, for what in them he ſaw was Evil (in private) that the Perſons themſelves have confeſſed, that they hoped his Chriſtian Reproofs would be for their Good, that they ſhould never forget them, for in them he did ſpeak to their Conſciences.

He had a Deſire to make a Will, to diſpoſe of what he had, that he might leave it as a Token of his Love to his Relations, and other of his Friends he had received Kindneſs from in his Sickneſs ; but would not do it until he had his Father's Conſent, which he deſired ; the which being granted, he diſpoſed of thoſe Things he had (though ſome of them were but Trifles) with as much Diſcretion and prudent Conſideration as if they had been Matters of the greateſt Moment, and he a Man of mature Judgment. Ordered alſo who ſhould dig his Grave ; expreſſed his deſire to die, and was heard praying for Death ; and told his Mother immediately before he died, he was now going to Heaven and that it would be beſt for her, that he ſhould die, for now ſhe was forced to take a great deal of Pains with him, but then ſhe'd be at Reſt : aſked her, if ſhe did not ſee it ſo, and wondered at her ſlowneſs to acknowledge it ; remembered his Love to his Relations, thankful to thoſe that had been often Watching with him, and prayed his Mother to remember them all with ſuch Tokens of his Love as were in his Power to give, nominating ſeveral particular Perſons ; and all this he ſpoke with great Chearfulneſs, and yet with Solemnity ; and ſo ſunk down in his Mother's Arms, and died quietly.

E X A M P L E



EXAMPLE IX.

EARLY PIETY exemplified in
Elizabeth Butcher.

SECTION I.

Containing a brief Account of her, from her Birth, July 1709, to her first remarkable Illness, in September 1716.

1. **E**LIZABETH BUTCHER, Daughter of *Alvin* and *Elizabeth Butcher of Boston*, was born July 14th 1709. Her Parents gave her up to God from the Womb, and as soon as she was capable of speaking they began to instruct her in the Things of God

2. When she was about Two Years and half Old; as she lay in the Cradle, she would ask herself that Question, What is my corrupt Nature? and would make Answer again to herself, It is empty of Grace, bent unto Sin, and only to Sin and that continually. She took great Delight in learning her Catechism, and would not willingly go to Bed without saying some Part of it.

3. She being a weakly Child, her Mother carried her into the Country for Health: And when she was about Three Years old and at Meeting, she would set with her Eyes fixed on the Minister, to the Admiration of all that sat about her, who said that grown up People might learn and take Example of her. She took great Delight in reading, and was ready and willing to receive Instruction.

4. But nothing more extraordinary as we remember appeared in her, till she came to be about Six Years old. Then she began to inquire concerning God, and the Nature and Affairs of her Soul, and she said she was afraid she had not lived up to that End for which she was made. She was asked

what was the End she was made for? The Child answered To glorify God: But I am afraid I have not lived to the Glory of God as I should have done. She was told that she must pray to God that He would please to pardon her Sins, and give her Grace to serve and glorify Him.

5. She was not contented with the bare reading of God's Word but would frequently ask the meaning of it. And when she was at her Work she would often ask where such and such Places of Scripture were, and would mention the Words that she might be directed to find them.

6. It was her practice to carry her Catechism, or some other good Book to Bed with her, and in the Morning she would be sitting up in her Bed reading before any of the Family were awake besides her.

7. One Day as she was sitting by the Fire, she ask'd—Why our first Parents eating the forbidden Fruit was counted Sin to them? At another Time she ask'd, Who were meant by the wise and foolish Virgins? And what was meant by the Oyl in the Lamps? As she she was reading a Sermon of Dr Cotton Mather's, she ask'd, Who was meant by the goodly Cedar? And when she was told, she said—And who are meant by the Fowls that are just fledged? She was told they meant little Children; and Christ called them to come to Him. But said she, How can I who am but a Child go to Christ? Being informed, she said,—But will Christ accept of me? she was answered, Yes, and several Places of Scripture were mentioned for her Encouragement.

SECTION II.

Containing a short Account of her in her first Illness, from September 1716 to February 1716-17.

1. **I**N September 1716, she was taken ill, and in her Sickness behaved herself with such wonderful Patience as all that came near admired. She would often put up that Request, Heavenly Father, Give me thy Christ, give me thy Grace, and pardon all my Sins, for Jesus Christ's Sake, Amen. Then she said, What is Sanctification? And made Answer to herself; It is the Work of God's free Grace.—

What

What are the Benefits which in this Life do accompany or flow from Justification, Adoption and Sanctification? They are Assurances of God's Love, Peace of Conscience, Joy in the Holy Ghost, Increase of Grace, and Perseverance therein to the End.

2. Being asked if she was willing to die, and go to Christ; she said, Yes: But Child, you know you are a Sinner: she said Yes: And you know where the Wicked go when they die; she said, Yes, they are cast into Hell: And being asked if she was not afraid of going thither: she said, No, for Christ is an all-sufficient Saviour, and He is able to save me, and I hope he will: Tho' I have not seen Christ, yet I hope I shall see Him.

3. A while after she said, I am weary of this World, and long to be gone: O when shall I go, O when shall I go! Her Mother asked her if she was willing to leave her here alone? She answered, Yes, For when you die I hope you will go to Heaven too.

4. She feeling an Alteration in herself, desired her Mother to send for Mr. Sewall; and when he came, he asked her, how she did? She answered, Very weak. He asked her, if she were willing to die? She said, Yes. He said, do you know you are a Sinner? she said Yes: He ask'd her, If she had not heard that there was another and better World than this? she answered, Yes. He asked her several other Questions, but they slip't my Memory. He was going to ask her one Question, but said it was a great one to ask a Child, but however he would, and said to her, Child, are you willing humbly to submit to the Will of God either for Life or Death? she said, Yes.

5. A while after she was weeping, and being asked the Reason, she said, I thought I saw the Flames of Hell and was going there, but I thought I saw Christ, and He call'd me to come to Him; and then I was not afraid; and I have cried to God for Grace to serve Him.

6. A while after she was taken with Convulsion Fits, and lay several Hours, all hopes of Recovery being taken away: But she reviving again, her Pain returned with greater Violence: She prayed to God to take her away out of this miserable

World,

World, and cried,—O God, my God, if thou wilt please to take me away, I will be willing to bear what Pain thou shalt please to lay upon me: O God, my dear God, I love Thee dearly! And this she repeated several Times over.

7. Her Mother sitting by her weeping, the Child said, Dear Mother, you make me have more Pain: Her Mother said, no my dear Child I don't; She said Yes, you cry, and that troubles me, and causes me to have more Pain.

8. Mr. Sewall being sent for again, He said, Child, Is it not better to be in Heaven with God and Christ, then to be here? she answered Yes, Yes. He ask'd her if he should pray to God that He would be pleased to take her to Himself? She made a quick Reply, doubling her Words, Yes, Yes. He asked her another Question, but being in great Trouble it slipped my Memory: But the Child made no Answer to it, and only said, I am spent.

9. A few Hours after, her Pains, abating again, the Fits returned with more Violence and held her several Hours and then left her. She lay for some Days so senseless that she knew not those that came to see her. But it pleased God to restore her to her former Health. And before she was able to sit up, she would call for her Book and lie and read by the Hour together.

SECTION III.

Containing a Brief Account of her from her first remarkable Illness in the Fall and Winter, 1716, to her second in April 1718.

1. **S**HE had by Course read almost through the Old-Testament; but at other Times her Delight was to read in the New, concerning the Birth of Christ and his Sufferings: and would ask the Meaning of what she read.

2. One Day as she sat by herself reading the 7th of the Revelations concerning the Number of them that were sealed; when she came to the 9th Verse, she was overheard to weep till she came to the End of the Chapter.

3. One Morning as she lay in her Bed she asked, what was meant by the Fountain, and the House of David, and the Inhabitants of Jerusalem, in Zechariah xii.

4. Hearing a Sermon from Luke xv. concerning the Prodigal Son; a few Days after she was saying the Text over to herself; she then ask'd, Who was meant by the Father? and who by the Son?

5. She had began to learn the Proofs of the Assembly's Catechism; and when she came to that in 1 Joh. v. 7. She asked if the Father was God, and if the Son was God also, and if the Holy Ghost was God also? For it is said here, That there are Three that bear Record in Heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost, and these Three are One: And this seems as if there were Three Gods, and yet there is but One. And she desired to be told something of this Mystery. She was told, There was but One GOD, tho' there were Three Persons in the Godhead. That Christ was the Eternal Son of God, and the same in Substance and equal with the Father in Power and Glory, and was God. Then said the Child, Tho' Christ be the Son of God, yet he is God also? Answer was made her, Yes: and that the Holy Ghost was the Spirit of God, and proceeded both from the Father and Son, and was the same in Substance with Them both and was equal in Power and Glory. And a while after she ask'd if Christ took upon him the Nature of a Man? She was told that He did.

6. She rejoiced greatly when Lord's Day came, especially if it were fair Weather for her to go the Publick Worship of God. And when she came Home, she would take a Book and sit and Read, till it was time to go to the Afternoon Exercise, without the least Sign of Weariness. And if she was detained at Home on the Sabbath; she would not spend the Day in Idleness, but in Religious Employments.

7. It pleased God to exercise her with great Pain in every Part of her Body, which did something impair the Natural Quickness and Strength of her Senses. But between two and three Months before her Death, her Understanding was brightned to Admiration.

8. When the Spring came on, and mention was made of the Publick Catechising; she rejoiced greatly, and would be often speaking of its drawing near. One Morning as she lay in her Bed, she said, *O that charming Day, O that sweet Day is coming*; Being asked, What Day she meant? She answered,

answered, *Catechising Day, I mean that sweet Day.* A few Days after she said, I won't depend upon going to Catechising, for I believe I shall be prevented by some Means or other. She has told, If she was well and the Weather permitted, nothing else would hinder her. *Ab!* said the Child, *I am perswaded I shall be prevented some way or other from going.* And according to the strong Impression she had upon her Mind, it proved to her: For she was taken sick two or three Days before the Catechising came, which was in *April 1718.*

SECTION IV.

Containing a more particular Account of her in her Second Illness, from April 1718, to June succeeding, when she died.

1. **W**HEN she was first taken, she was in some Doubt of her Spiritual State, and said, she was afraid she did not belong to God, nor love Him as she should; For Mother, you have told me, That they who fear God and love Him, would make it their chief Care and Endeavour to keep His Commandments; But I am afraid I have not kept them as I ought. Her Mother ask'd her What particular Command she could accuse her self of Breaking? She said, The Fifth Commandment saith, *Honour thy Father and thy Mother*; and have I honoured You? have I obey'd you as I ought, Her Mother told her; You have been an obedient child to me, and wherein you have offended in any small Matter I do forgive you, and pray God to forgive you also.

2. The Day following she cried out, I am a great Sinner, a great Sinner, What will become of me! O what will become of me! I am afraid that God will not have Mercy on me! my Sins are so many and so great. She was told, Tho' her Sins were ever so great and many, yet the Mercy of God was greater and more abundant than her Sins; for that was, like Himself, Infinite, and endureth forever. That there was Forgiveness with Him that He might be feared, and He had promised, that those who confess, and forsake their Sins should find mercy. But said the Child, Satan tempts me to despair of Mercy, because my Sins are so great and many. But she was then exhorted not to give

way to the Temptations of Satan, but to hope in the Mercy of God : For the Lord taketh Pleasure in them that fear Him, and in them that hope in His Mercy. And she was told that He saith in Isa. lv. 7 Let the wicked forsake his Way, and the unrighteous Man his Thoughts, and let him return unto the Lord, and he will have Mercy upon him, and to our God: for He will abundantly pardon.

3. A while after she said, Behold I was shapen in Iniquity, and in Sin did my Mother conceive me: I am a miserable and sinful Creature : Convinc'd I am of Sin, but afraid not Converted: I am a poor Creature that has no Sight of my Interest in Christ, and without a Christ, without a Christ, I am undone forever : Oh for a Christ, O for a Christ, for a Christ to save me ! And then she prayed and said—

4. LORD, have Mercy on me according to thy Loving Kindness; according to the Multitude of thy Tender Mercies blot out all my Transgressions with thine own Blood: Wash me thoroughly from mine Iniquities, and cleanse me from my Sins. Create in me a clean Heart, O God, and renew a right Spirit within me: O give me a new Heart, a humble Heart, a broken Heart, and a contrite Spirit; Oh sanctify me by thy holy Spirit throughout, in Soul, Spirit, and Body: Renew me in the whole Man after thine own Image, in Knowledge, Righteousness and true Holiness: Oh give me a Christ, give me thy Grace, pardon all my Sins: O Lord, take away all mine Iniquities, and receive me graciously, circumcise my Heart to fear thy Name, and lead me in the Way that is pleasing in thy Sight: Oh be my God in Life, my Guide unto Death, and the unchangeable Portion of my Soul for ever: Fit and prepare me for all Changes, but especially for Death, my great and last Change; And this I beg for thy Son Jesus Christ's Sake. *Amen.*

5. In the Time of her Health she was very careful of her Words, and no ill Language was ever heard to proceed from her Lips. Yet now in her Sicknefs, she examined herself, what Sins she had been guilty of, both in Words and Actions. And taking a View of the Commandments, some of them she said she was afraid she had been guilty of

breaking, and did accuse herself of Disobedience, and condemned herself for her Sins. And being in great Pain of Body, she said, Now I am suffering the Desert of my Sins : Oh that I might have but a Moment's Ease : But I need not wonder that I have no Ease, for I deserve none : Have Mercy upon me, O Lord, for I am weak ; O Lord, heal me, for my Bones are sore vexed : Look upon my Affliction and my Pain, and forgive all my Sins.

6. Mr *Prince* came in to see her : She desired him to pray with her : He asked her what he should pray for ? she answered, That God would be pleas'd to pardon all her Sins, and give her an Interest in Christ.

7. A while after she cried out, Oh I am a poor Creature that wants Assurance : Oh for Assurance, Oh for Assurance ! Oh that God wou'd be pleas'd to lift up the Light of his Countenance upon me ! O that he wou'd be pleas'd to own me in his Covenant, and bless me. Her Mother seeing her in this Distress, ask'd her if she should send for Mr. *Sewall* to talk with him, and hear what he had to say to her ? The Child answered, Mr. *Sewall* may give me some Encouragement as you do, but except God speaks to me too, all will signify nothing. Well Child, says her Mother, Wait upon God still, who will in his own Time, I hope, speak Peace to thy Soul. Mr. *Sewall* was sent for, but he was not at Home.

8. She was told for her Encouragement, That she was a Lamb of Christ's Flock ; and that he had said, He would take the Lambs in his Arms, and carry them in his Bosom ; and suffer little Children to come unto me, and forbid them not, for of such is the Kingdom of Heaven ; and you know that Promise in Prov. viii. 17. I love them that love me, and those that seek me early shall find me. The Child answered, If the Lord will please to help me, I will seek him. She was told that the Lord would help her, and was exhorted to trust in the Free Grace and Mercy of God through Christ. Oh said the Child, I am willing to accept of Christ, but I am afraid Christ is not willing : Answer was made, that if she was willing to accept of Christ, that to be sure Christ was willing to accept her : She answered, I am willing.

9. A while after she said; I will venture my Soul upon Christ, and if I perish, Lord, it shall be at the Fountain of thy Mercy: For thou hast promised, that whosoever cometh unto thee, thou wilt in no wise cast out; O Lord, I desire as I am able, to come unto thee, and I am sure thou wilt not cast me off. And she was compos'd for some Time: But Satan assaulted her again in setting her Sins before her; and she cried out, Oh the Sin of my Nature (unless my Soul be sprinkled with the Blood of Christ) is enough to undo me, were I guilty of no other.

10. About a Month before her Death, on the Sabbath in the Afternoon, she said to her Mother; Now I have a believing Sight of Christ: Now Christ is mine, and I am his: Oh, how sweet is Christ: O he is sweet, he is sweet! and if you did but Taste and Feel what I do, you would long to be gone. Then she said, Come Lord Jesus, come quickly: Dear Jesus, sweet Jesus, come quickly. Then she said, Lord Jesus give me Patience, give me Patience to wait thy Time, for thy Time is the best Time: Lord Jesus give me Patience.

11. Her Mother sat weeping by her, and to comfort her, the Child said; Dear Mother, though we part now, it will be but a little while before you will follow and come to me; and that will be a happy Meeting for us, to meet at the Right Hand of Christ in the Great Day. Then she thanked her Mother for the Instructions and Corrections she had given her, and said, Had it not been for them I might have gone to Hell; but it won't be long now before the blessed Angels will come and carry my Soul to the Bosom of Christ; Oh I long to be gone, I long to be gone to that blessed Place: Sweet Lord Jesus, come quickly.

12. A while after she said, My Pain is great which I undergo to go to Christ; but not so great as the Pains Christ underwent for me: Oh I wonder, I wonder, that Christ shou'd be so willing to die for me, who am so great a Sinner.

13. Mr. Sewall was sent for again; but before he came the Child was so spent with extream Pain and much Speaking, that she was not able to say any Thing to him. In the Night she ask'd the young Woman that watch'd with her, to read the 25th of *Matthew* to her.

14. One Morning she ask'd, Where is that Place of Scripture? Eat O Friends, Drink, yea Drink abundantly, O Beloved. The Glass standing on the Table, she ask'd her to have it turned, and said, My Glass is almost run, my Work is almost ended.

15. On Thursday was three Weeks before her Death, her Mother seeing an alteration in her, said, My Child is struck with Death. Upon which she replied, Is Death come, and am I prepared, am I prepared? She lay still for some Time, and then said, O Death where is thy Sting, O Grave where is thy Victory, and what wilt thou gain by this Thing?

16. There was a Person she had a peculiar Respect for, and desired her Mother when she had an Opportunity, to speak to her; for she was afraid she did not consider her Soul and Eternity.

17. The Lord's-Day following she said over the 23d Psalm, and when she had concluded it, her Mother ask'd her if she was not afraid to pass through the dark Valley of the Shadow of Death? she answered, No, for God hath promised that he will never leave me nor forsake me, neither will he suffer me to leave or forsake him.

18. She lying in great Pain Day and Night would often say, Lord Jesus give me Patience, give me Patience, that I may not dishonour God, she said, Oh if I should be deceiv'd at last, and deceive others, and they think I am good, Oh how miserable shall I be forever?

19. Her Aunt *Stone* being present, and the Child being in great Pain, and complaining of those about her for refusing to do something for her, which she found relieved her, but they were fearful of overdoing, she said—They do not pity me, but I hope Christ pities me, and will prepare a Place for me. A little while after, being restless with her Pains, she check'd herself, saying,—Why do I complain? Christ endur'd more than this for me: I wonder how he did to bear it. And a little while after hearing it Thunder, she said, It Thunders, I am afraid God will kill me with it; but whether he kills me with that, or with this Pain, if I may but go to Christ, it will be well.

20. The Tuesday following Mr. *Sewall* came to see her, and after some Discourse, he ask'd her on what she depended for Salvation? She replied, On Christ, and the Promises. He said, well Child hold fast thy Faith, and still trust in Christ. Then she said, Oh I long to be gone to that blessed Place. He asked her what blessed Place? She not readily answering, he said, do you mean Heaven? She answered Yes: And when he was going away, desir'd him to remember her in his Prayers: And ask'd him when he would please to come again to see her?

21. Two Persons being in the Room, they said to one another, this Child has been a Child of Affliction all its Days. The Child replied, And it is for my good.

22. She had another Combat with Satan, and said He would perswade her that Christ was withdrawn from her; And she cried out, Oh what shall I do, Oh what shall I do? I am undone! She said, O Lord, cast me not out of thy Sight; cast me not away from thy Presence, and take not thy holy Spirit from me: Restore unto me the Joy of thy Salvation, and uphold me with thy free Spirit; never leave me nor forsake me: But guide me by thy Counsel while here, and afterwards receive me to thine heavenly Kingdom: And this I ask for thy Son Jesus Christ's Sake; and in Testimony of my Desires and Assurance to be heard, I say, Amen.

23. She was comforted again in the Night: And the Watcher sitting by her Bed-side, about Midnight, heard her say,
Yonder, Yonder, up above,
Sits my Saviour, cloath'd in Love,
And there's my smiling God.

24. She said she had something to say to Mr. *Sewall* the next Time he should come to see her: And being asked what it was, she said, She would thank him for the many Prayers he put up for her, for God had heard and answer'd them.

25. At another Time she said concerning Christ: Why is thy Chariot so long a coming? Why stay so long the Wheels of his Chariot? For me to stay is Pain; but to die is Gain.

26. Mr. *Prince* coming to see her the Monday before her Death, she desired him to pray with her: He said, well, and
 what

what shall we pray for now? She replied, That I may have a saving knowledge of Christ, that God wou'd please to pardon all my Sins, and prepare me for Death my great and last Change

27. The Day following her Pains abated, and she seemed to be better for two or three Days; and no one perceiv'd her to draw near her Change till a few Minutes before she was taken Speechless, the Child said something choak'd her: Her Mother felt of her Hands, and finding them in a cold sweat, and her Countenance alter, she said, my Child is a going: Ah Mother, said the Child, So must you as well as I. She said something more; but her Speech and Spirits failing, we could not understand her.

She breath'd her Soul into the Arms of Christ on Friday, the 13h Day of June 1718, being Eight Years and just Eleven Months Old.

Happy the Parents, and the Pastors be,
Bringing thy little Ones, Great GOD, to Thee!
How pleasant 'tis to see them safe from Harms.
Lov'd and embrac'd in CHRIST's out stretched Arms!
That this great KING may Mansions fitly fill,
He lifts for Church-triumphant whom he will.

E X A M P L E X.

MISS ABIEL GOODWIN, who died at *Boston* October 3, 1727, in the 20th Year of her Age.

Her Father died a very young Man but in so uncommon and victorious a Manner that an Account is already published of it in Dr. Cotton Mather's *Cælestinus*. She was born after the Death of her Father, and for that Cause the Name of ABIEL [or, God my Father] was given her.

This young Person was one who began Betimes to take the Yoke of her Saviour upon her; yea so much Betimes, and with such gracious Dawns of Piety, that she knew not the Time of her first coming into the Life of GOD. And GOD forbid that we should rashly pass the Doom of the Unregenerate on all who are, and very many of the Newborn, we hope, are so circumstanced.

Under the Influences of a pious Education, she was from her Childhood used unto the Religion of the Closet; and afraid of doing any Thing that the Light of God in her young Soul allowed not: And courteous, affable and full of Benignity, ready to do good Offices for all about her: Accompanied and advantaged with a Discretion which was an agreeable Varnish upon all.

Her Attendance on the Means of Grace was very diligent and vigilant: Wherein among the rest, she constantly attended the Weekly Lectures; and lamented the Scandal of it, that those precious Opportunities were so shamefully neglected in a City were a worldly Mind so evidently governed the Inhabitants.

Hereby she came so to live by the Faith of the SON of GOD, and of his everlasting Love to her, that the Dread of Death was nobly conquered in her: And in the Year 1721, when the Small-Pox carried off so many Hundreds in the City of Boston, she declared unto her Widow Mother, that except God had some Service for her to do, more particularly in being very helpful to her, she would have chose then to have left a World, that she saw full of little but Sin and Vanity.

Her Illness began upon her, when she was little more than Sixteen Years of Age, and she was confined unto the House for two Years before she died. Hereby she was prevented from the Execution of a Purpose, that her young Heart was earnestly set upon, Which was to have approached the Holy-Table in the Way of the Gospel and of our Churches, and have made her Claim to the Sacrifice of her Saviour, and set her Seal to the Covenant of Salvation, according to his Institution there. She greatly lamented it, that though she was so very young she had not publicly done what she purposed of giving herself up unto the Lord among his People! But she said I have done it privately a Thousand Times! And the Lord has accepted my Willing Mind; and what Fault there might be in my Delay, he has assured me, that he pardoned it. But how urgently did she urge upon her young Friends, the serious and speedy discharge of their plain Duty, *Do This*; the Omission whereof does forever, where the Conscience is not seared, make an uneasy Death Bed!

At length she became confined unto the Bed, for eighteen Weeks together, at her Entrance whereof she expressed a strong Belief, that she should find extraordinary Supports provided for her. And she found them! Found them to astonishment.

She was now fallen into an Hydropical Condition. In this Time, though many wearisome Nights were appointed for her, yet she possessed not Months of Vanity. But she did Good all the While, and brought forth much of the Fruit, by which her heavenly Father has been and will be glorified.

In these Months, the first Thing that I take Notice of, is, the Zeal, and Flame, and Ardour, wherewith she addressed her lively Exhortations unto those that visited her; to make haste unto their Saviour, and into a Life of Piety, and make sure of, and lay hold on eternal Life. She did not much offer her Exhortations of this Importance unto elder People; for she said she did not count it good Manners for her to do the Part of a Monitor, to those who were much older than herself. But with younger People she was inexpressibly in Earnest, That they would now, now, even to Day, hear the Voice of God, and remember their Creator, and be at no Rest, Give no sleep to their Eyes, nor Slumber to their Eye-lids, 'till they had got into the Covenant of God their Saviour and yielded themselves unto the Lord, resolving to be the Lord's. As a wise Winner of Souls, how sweetly did she invite them, Oh! Come and sit under the Shadow of your Saviour! Sweet, Sweet will you find his Fruit unto you. Great Numbers of younger People came to her, and she not only very importunately but also very particularly expostulated with them about their Delay to make thorough Work of that Conversion to God, and Resort unto the Wings of the SAVIOUR, which was infinitely necessary, in order to their dying in Safety and with Comfort. She took several by the Hand, vehemently soliciting them to consent unto the Proposal in the *Covenant of Life*, and resign and engage themselves unto their Saviour; and would not let go their Hand until they declared unto her, *That they did so*. She pleaded with some of them; "GOD spared you in the

"Time

"Time of the great Mortality six Years ago: He has come twice three Years, looking for Fruit. But Oh! What Fruit has he found upon you!" And some in whom she saw Things amiss, it was very affecting to see how lovingly, but how faithfully and how solemnly she dispensed Reproofs unto them. The *Hammers* were enough to have *broken Rocks to Pieces!*

In this Time as it sometimes is with Souls that are getting loose from Flesh, and gotten very far on towards the invisible World, she had some unaccountable Impressions upon her Mind, relating to Things not commonly coming under human Cognizance. There were surprising Instances, and not so proper to be now and here spoken of. But there is one I would speak of because it may be a little subservient unto the main Design which I am now to prosecute.

In her Inculcations of it upon young People, that they would immediately come under the Yoke of their Saviour, and so be prepared for a Death, which they knew not how suddenly it might overtake them: She said, "Mind what I say; you shall see Sudden Deaths, I say, Sudden Deaths, quickly multiplied among you; and Young as well as Old shall be reached with them."

It was not long, but a very few Weeks after this Prediction, before she was able to observe, "Well, there have been fourteen Sudden Deaths, which you have seen dispensed since my speaking to you; but I am to tell you, there will yet be many more than these."

But from this, I cannot but go on, and take Notice of the Prospect that her Saviour gave her of the Heaven, that she now saw open to receive her; and the heavenly Peace and Joy, which the bright Prospect filled her withal.

It was unspeakably edifying unto us, to see so young a Person, one of Nineteen, so rejoicing in Hope of the Glory of God: Yea, rejoicing with a Joy unspeakable and full of Glory.

In this Time, when one, to treat her with a Term that might suit her Ingenuity, told her, that considering the Name

of her Malady, her Condition might be called, *A going to Heaven by Water*: And that anon she would be able to sing unto her Saviour, that Song of the Redeemed; He sent from above, he took me, he drew me out of many Waters! Her answer was, "Water! Yea, and if I should go to Heaven by Fire too, I am sure, Heaven would compensate for all the Trouble of it. O! lovely, lovely, lovely, to be there! How do I long to be there!" Then she would break out, "Oh! That I had the Wings of a Dove, then would I fly away unto him, and be at rest! And again, Oh! why is his Chariot so long a coming? Why tarry the Wheels of his Chariot?" But she corrected it, saying, "I will wait, for he that will come shall come, and will not tarry. And, Oh! what shall I find in Mount Sion, the City of the living God, the heavenly Jerusalem."

She said, that for some time, though she knew it would be well with her, yet she was at a Loss, and knew not how far her departed Soul would apprehend Things in the other World which it was now going to. But when her Thoughts were one Day full of Perplexity about the Matter, she thought she heard a Voice distinctly say to her, "Be satisfied, thy departing Soul shall immediately pass into a wondrous Glory. Thy poor Body shall also still remain united unto thy Redeemer, and it shall be after some time restored unto thy Soul, with wondrous Glory; and therein thou shalt for ever glorify him who has redeemed thee." The Scriptures being so set in this Light unto her, she broke forth into Raptures, Oh wonderful! O wonderful! Am I so near unto a wonderful Glory, and this vile Body too united to my Saviour, and regarded by him!—O Grace! Grace!—O free Grace! O rich Grace!—I shall glorify thee for evermore. It was also a frequent Exclamation with her, O the Grace of the glorious Rock of Ages! I have everlasting Strength in that glorious Rock of Ages!

She said upon her being asked her choice in the Matter; I had rather die, were it the Will of God, if it were for nothing but this; If I live I shall sin: You know now it is natural to sin; and I had rather die than sin. But if it be
the

the Will of God that I should live, I am willing to live and suffer any Thing that he shall please to order for me. It will be nothing to what my Saviour suffered for me the chief of Sinners.

She often fell into Fits, which were attended with an Extrémity of Pains: But at her first coming out of them, her first Words were usually such as one might have expected from one that had been caught up to Paradise: They were, *Hallelujah! Oh! Salvation to our GOD, who sitteth on the Throne, and unto the Lamb, O Blessing and Glory and Honour be unto our GOD, for ever and ever!*—She said, *O welcome Fits, O welcome Pains, O welcome any Thing that will bring me nearer to CHRIST!* She said, *Well, the more I bear, the more I love! The more I suffer from the wise and good Hand of my SAVIOUR, the more I love Him!*—Her Mother wiping the Sweat off her Face; hereupon she said, *O my Mother, 'tis not like the Drops of Blood, which my Saviour shed for me a miserable Sinner.* One, with some Compassion, saying, *Poor Creature!* She replied, *I don't call me so; I am a rich Creature; for the Blood of the Son of God has cleansed me from all my Sins; and his unsearchable Riches are mine!* Another using the Term of *Distress'd Creature!* she said upon it, *No, say, Happy Creature!* She lay awake with her Eyes closed a long time together? And being at length asked, *What she was doing?* she replied, "I am thinking, thinking, what that Heaven is " which I am going to. Thinking how they are employed " in Heaven! I now know a little of that.—Thinking what " shall be my first Word when I come to Heaven." Being asked, *What it should be?* she answered, *HALLELUJAH! HALLELUJAH! HALLELUJAH!* O the free and rich Grace which has brought me hither! O my Saviour, what, what, shall I render to thee!"

Coming to speak about the matchless Glories of her Saviour, she said, "I have read and heard, his Name is *Wonderful*. O! I did not understand the meaning of that Word: But now I have some understanding of it. I have heard and read, *He is altogether lovely.* O I did not know the meaning of that Word; but now I know something of it!"

Once a Temptation assaulted her, that a *Devil* would make a Prey of her *departing Soul*. But she soon answered it, and vanquished it, and said, "No, No, my Saviour won't let Satan pluck me out of his powerful and merciful Hand. Satan, when my Hour comes, my Flight will be too nimble for thee." Hereupon she expressed, in very extraordinary Terms how *welcome* her Death was become unto her. It came unto her, as one *that comes to take off the Yoke on the Jews, and lay Meat unto the weary*. Being asked, *If she was not frightened at it?* She replied, "Frightened! No, "my Saviour has made it a better Friend unto me than "any I have in the World. O my Friend, how welcome, "how welcome to me." The Tolls of the Bells for Funerals even transported her, to think what Joys the like Tolls for her would proclaim her to be gone unto. And she sent Messages unto some sick People in the Neighbourhood, "That they should not be afraid of dying; but repair to "the glorious CHRIST that she had repaired unto: And "they should find him full of Grace; full of Love; the "Comforter that should relieve their Souls would not be far "from them." She therewithal declared, that there was *one Word*, which the Spirit of GOD had made worth a thousand Worlds, even that Word, *Our light Affliction here, which is but for a Moment, works for us a far more exceeding, and eternal Weight of Glory.*

But I must now own, that though her hope in her Death, was what appeared very admirable to me and very delectable, yet there was one Thing that appeared much more so: and this was, Her being willing to live.

Though she so wished for Death, and had such Assurance that the Hour of Death would be the best Hour that ever she saw: and though the Distemper which cruciated her, had had very much colour and anguish in it, and at and by her Expiration, she was assured of the Lord sending to take her and draw her out of deadly Waters: Yet with the most profound Submission, she was willing to wait GOD's Time for the Deliverance. Her Will was admirably swallowed up in the Will of her GOD; and her Cry continually was, *The Will of the Lord be done!*

How often did she so comfort her self, "Heaven, Heaven will make Amends for all the Pains that I undergo in my Passage to it !" How often did she compose herself; "If I may do Good unto any one Soul by my staying here, or if I do no more Good than this, that the Sight of my Pain shall teach any to be thankful to God for their Health and Ease: This alone will make Amends for all my Misery." She would often speak of Sufferings for Christ, and say, Oh what a Pleasure it would be unto her to be burnt to Death for him. And Sufferings from Christ, she often said, she could bear them with Pleasure, because they came from him. Any Thing from his Hand, she said, Oh ! 'Tis a Pleasure to take it ! — Thus Patience had its perfect Work. This Patience did finish the Work of the Yoke upon her.

Being asked, How she did ? she answered, "Oh ! Better and Better ! — That is to say, Nigher and Nigher to Heaven !" A little before she died, being ask'd Whether her Comfort continued ? she said, "Yes, Oh ! more than ever ! But I am so weak, that I cannot express the Joy I feel. I long more than ever to be gone ! You may now look for my Death every Minute."

Some of her last Words were, I have now finished the Work that my God has ordered for me ! —

So she slept waiting for the Mercy Stroke, which anon released her.

The End of the EXAMPLES.



*From Dr. WATTS's DIVINE SONGS for the
Use of CHILDREN.*

The Advantages of Early Religion.

HAPPY's the Child, whose youngest Years
Receive Instruction well;
Who hates the Sinner's Path, and fears
The Road that leads to Hell,

When we devote our Youth to God,
'Tis pleasing in his Eyes;
A Flower when offer'd in the Bud
Is no vain Sacrifice.

'Tis easier Work, if we begin
To fear the Lord betimes;
While Sinners that grow old in Sin,
Are hardned in their Crimes.

'Twill save us from a Thousand Snares,
To mind Religion young;
Grace will preserve our following Years,
And make our Virtue strong.

To Thee, Almighty God, to Thee,
Our Childhood we resign;
'Twill please us to look back and see
That our whole Lives were thine.

Let the sweet Work of Prayer and Praise,
Employ our youngest Breath;
Thus I'm prepar'd for longer Days,
Or fit for early Death.

The Danger of Delay.

WHY should I say, 'Tis yet too soon,
 To seek for Heav'n, or think of Death?
 A Flower may fade before 'tis Noon,
 And I this Day may lose my Breath.

If this rebellious Heart of mine
 Despise the gracious Calls of Heaven;
 I may be harden'd in my Sin,
 And never have Repentance given.

What if the Lord grow wroth, and swear,
 While I refuse to read and pray,
 That he'll refuse to lend an Ear
 To all my Groans another Day.

What if his dreadful Anger burn,
 While I refuse his offer'd Grace,
 And all his Love to Fury turn,
 And strike me dead upon the Place?

'Tis dangerous to provoke a God,
 Whose Power and Vengeance none can tell;
 One Stroke of his Almighty Rod
 Shall send young Sinners quick to Hell.

Then 'twill forever be in vain,
 To cry for Pardon and for Grace,
 To wish I had my Time again,
 Or hope to see my Maker's Face.

Examples of EARLY PIETY.

WHAT blest'd Examples do I find
 Writ in the Word of Truth;
 Of Children that began to mind
 Religion in their Youth.

JESUS, who reigns above the Sky,
 And keeps the World in awe,
 Was once a Child as young as I,
 And kept his Father's Law.

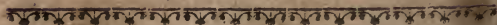
At twelve Years old he talk'd with Men,
 (The *Jews* all wondring stand)
 Yet he obey'd his Mother then,
 And came at her Command.

Children a sweet *Hosanna* sung;
 And blest'd their Saviour's Name :
 And gave him Honour with their Tongue,
 While Scribes and Priests blaspheme.

Samuel the Child was wean'd and brought
 To wait upon the Lord ;
 Young *Timothy* betimes was taught
 To know his holy word.

Then why should I so long delay,
 What others learn so soon ?
 I would not pass another Day,
 Without this Work begun.

T H E E N D.



1875

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John Jun.
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John Tom

John Tom

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